

ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal — System Manual

How the system works and how to use it: every screen, every role, KoboToolbox, data, security and administration.

STUDY	Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)
PRINCIPAL RESEARCHER	Happyson Saina, Doctor of Strategic Management candidate, Chinhoyi University of Technology
SUPERVISORS	Dr L. Chikazhe and Dr J. Kanyepe
FOR	The whole research team: PI, coordinators, research assistants, analysts and supervisors
SYSTEM ADDRESS	https://research.agribizframework.com
CONTACT	0773943709 · abffst.research@gmail.com
VERSION	Version 1.10 · 22 September 2026

Screenshots in this document use **fictional demonstration data**. Organisation and person names, phone numbers and figures shown in them are not real study records.

Contents

1. About this manual	5
2. The study and the system.....	6
2.1 The study	6
2.2 What the portal is — and is not.....	6
2.3 The parts of the system	6
3. How the system works	8
3.1 The journey of a case, end to end	8
3.2 Identifiers	8
3.3 Sample, strata and Reserves	9
3.4 Workflow statuses (S00–S16)	9
3.5 Invitations.....	9
3.6 Eligibility and consent (the gates)	10
3.7 PROIT — pre-interview profiling, with AI research	10
3.8 KoboToolbox integration.....	10
3.9 Quality assurance	11
3.10 Reminders and nonresponse.....	11
3.11 Withdrawal	12
3.12 The KII and documentary strands.....	12
3.13 Monitoring, reports and exports	12
3.14 Security and privacy controls	12
4. Getting started	14
Signing in	14
Finding your way around.....	14
Changing your password	15
5. Roles and permissions	16
5.1 Who can do what	16
6. Screen reference	18
6.1 Executive, Sampling and Contact dashboards.....	18
6.2 Reports	19
6.3 QA Dashboard.....	20
6.4 KII/Doc Dashboard.....	21
6.5 Main-400 Register	21
6.6 Case page.....	22
6.7 Organisations.....	23
6.8 Appointments	23
6.9 Follow-ups	23
6.10 Form PDFs.....	24
6.11 QA Queue and QA Exceptions	24

6.12 KII Register and KII record	24
6.13 Documents and document record.....	24
6.14 Reserve Activation, Cost, Audit Log, Export, Change password.....	24
7. Procedures, step by step	25
7.1 Dashboards (all monitoring roles)	25
7.2 Reports (PI, FC, Analyst, Supervisor)	25
7.3 Registering an organisation (PI, FC).....	28
7.4 Pairing a Reserve and assigning a Contact RA (PI, FC).....	29
7.5 Bulk verification to SO3 (PI, FC).....	29
7.6 Recording respondents and contact details (PI, FC, Contact RA)	30
7.7 Sending an invitation (PI, FC, Contact RA)	30
7.8 Logging a contact attempt (PI, FC, Contact RA).....	31
7.9 Sending follow-up reminders (PI, FC, Contact RA)	32
7.10 Managing appointments (PI, FC, Contact RA)	33
7.11 Assisted administration (RAs).....	33
7.12 Activating a Reserve (PI, FC)	34
7.13 QA review (PI, FC, QA RA).....	34
7.14 QA exceptions (PI, FC, QA RA)	36
7.15 Form PDFs and emailing (PI, FC, QA/KII/Doc RA)	36
7.16 KII records (PI, FC, KII RA)	37
7.16a Taking a KII from invitation to coded transcript	38
7.16b Opening the KII Guide with the KII ID filled in.....	39
7.17 Document records (PI, FC, Documentary RA).....	40
7.17a Coding another chapter of the same document (Copy for another chapter)	41
7.17b Adding a document by hand	41
7.17c Correcting a record's details	42
7.17d Attaching the source file, and removing a wrong one	42
7.17e Assessing and including a document.....	43
7.17f Coding a document: two ways	44
7.17g Auto-fill: the AI drafts, you review	44
7.18 Logging costs (PI, FC)	50
7.19 Downloading data (PI, FC, Analyst)	51
7.20 Audit log (PI)	52
7.21 Manual status changes (PI, FC, Contact RA).....	52
7.22 Recording a withdrawal (PI, FC).....	53
7.23 When the person is not eligible.....	54
7.24 PROIT pre-interview profile with AI research (PI, FC).....	54
7.25 Reassigning cases in bulk (PI, FC).....	56
7.26 Verifying a profile with the respondent and reconciling it (FC, PI, KII RA, Contact RA)	57
8. The respondent's experience	59

8.1 Message templates.....	60
9. KoboToolbox administration (PI).....	61
9.1 The connected forms.....	61
9.2 Changing a form	61
9.3 Instrument decisions (PI, 15 September 2026)	61
9.4 Rotating the KoboToolbox password and API token	61
10. System administration.....	63
10.1 Creating and managing accounts (PI)	63
10.2 Server operations (technical administrator)	63
10.3 Backups.....	64
11. Data protection and ethics in practice	65
11.1 What respondents are told (PIS v1.4, summary).....	65
12. Troubleshooting	66
12.1 Staff	66
12.2 Respondents	66
13. Glossary	68
Appendix A. Quick reference.....	70
Administration modes	70

1. About this manual

This manual explains the ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal from end to end: what it is for, how its parts fit together, what every screen does, and how to carry out each task. It is the reference document for the whole team.

Document	Read it if you are
System Manual (this document)	Anyone who needs the complete picture, especially the PI and Field Coordinator.
Screen and Button Reference	Anyone who wants to know what every button does, why it exists and what happens next.
Role Guide 1 — PI / System Admin	The Principal Investigator.
Role Guide 2 — Field / Digital Coordinator	Running day-to-day fieldwork.
Role Guide 3 — Contact RA	Contacting and inviting organisations.
Role Guide 4 — QUAN/Kobo QA RA	Checking questionnaire quality.
Role Guide 5 — KII RA	Running Key Informant Interviews.
Role Guide 6 — Documentary RA	Collecting and assessing documents.
Role Guide 7 — Data Analyst	Monitoring progress and analysing de-identified data.
Role Guide 8 — Supervisor	Overseeing the study read-only.
Respondent Guide	A respondent, or briefing one.

Conventions

- Names of buttons, fields and screens are in **bold**, exactly as they appear on screen.
- Codes and system values look like S03 or consent_withdrawn.
- Tip** boxes (blue) give helpful advice. **Important** boxes (amber) protect data quality, respondents or the research design.
- Screenshots use fictional demonstration data. Your screens show the real study records.

2. The study and the system

2.1 The study

The portal supports the doctoral study **Developing and Validating the Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation through Novel Financing Models in Zimbabwe (ABF-FST)**, by Happyson Saina (Doctor of Strategic Management candidate, Chinhoyi University of Technology), supervised by Dr L. Chikazhe and Dr J. Kanyepe.

Quantitative strand	400 completed questionnaires from the Main-400 sample of agribusiness organisations, with 400 matched Reserve organisations for replacement.
Qualitative strand	60 completed Key Informant Interviews (90 KII records loaded: Core-60 plus Reserve-30).
Documentary strand	50–75 coded documents, digital platform and media sources (100 records loaded).
Data lock	30 November 2026.
Approvals	Ethics and POTRAZ covered by the PI's CUT research clearance; Participant Information Sheet (v1.3), QA thresholds, invitation and reminder wording, and PROIT approved by the PI on 15 September 2026. The PIS is now v1.4 (2026-09-22, study contact email only).

2.2 What the portal is — and is not

- It **is** the research operations system: it controls the sample, invites and tracks respondents, records eligibility and consent, launches the KoboToolbox questionnaire with the right identifiers, reconciles submissions, runs quality assurance, supports the KII and documentary strands, and produces monitoring, reports and exports.
- It is **not** a public survey. Nobody can browse in: every respondent starts from a personal invitation link.
- It **never** calculates or shows a score, rating or financing decision to anyone taking part.
- It does **not** replace KoboToolbox. The questionnaire, KII Guide and Document Analysis Tool live in KoboToolbox; the portal manages everything around them.

2.3 The parts of the system

Part	What it does	Who uses it
Respondent portal	Public pages at https://research.agribizframework.com/i/... that walk an invited respondent through confirmation, eligibility, information, consent and choice of how to take part.	Respondents
Research Operations Centre	The internal system at https://research.agribizframework.com/admin : registers, case pages, invitations, follow-ups, QA, KII, documents, costs, dashboards, reports and exports.	Research team (8 roles)
KoboToolbox	Hosts the three forms: Main Study Questionnaire, Main Study KII Guide, and Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool. Stores the answers.	Respondents and RAs (forms); PI (form design)

Part	What it does	Who uses it
Background jobs	Pull submissions from KoboToolbox (every 15 minutes by day, hourly overnight), compute reminders due, and check nonresponse.	Automatic
Email	Sends completed-form PDFs from abffst.research@gmail.com.	Automatic, on request
Backups	Database and private files every 4 hours on the server, copied encrypted to Google Drive once enabled.	Automatic

3. How the system works

This chapter follows one organisation from selection to a quality-assured questionnaire, then covers the KII and documentary strands and the controls that protect the data.

3.1 The journey of a case, end to end

Stage	What happens	Who	Status
1. Selected	The organisation is in the approved Main-400 register with its matched Reserve.	Loaded	S00
2. Assigned	The case is assigned to a Contact RA.	PI / Coordinator	S00
3. Verified	The organisation is confirmed and an eligible senior respondent identified; contact details are recorded.	Coordinator / Contact RA	S01 → S03
4. Profiled (optional)	Public background facts are recorded with sources and locked (PROIT).	Researcher + reviewer	S03
5. Invited	A personal link is issued and sent by WhatsApp, SMS or email.	Contact RA	S05 (auto)
6. Opened	The respondent opens the link, confirms the organisation and their role.	Respondent	S06 (auto)
7. Consent	The respondent reads the Participant Information Sheet v1.4 and agrees.	Respondent	—
8. Questionnaire	The respondent opens the KoboToolbox questionnaire (or books a researcher-assisted session).	Respondent / RA	S07 (auto)
9. Submitted	KoboToolbox notifies the portal; the submission is matched to the case and checked by the QA rules.	Automatic	S08 (auto)
10. Reminders	If no submission, approved reminders fall due on Day 2 and Day 7.	Contact RA	S05–S07
11. QA decision	A QA reviewer accepts, re-queries or rejects, always with a note.	QA RA	S10 / S09 (auto)
12. Completed	The case is closed.	Coordinator	S11
If it drops out	Refusal, nonresponse, ineligibility or duplication is recorded; the matched Reserve is activated with a reason and evidence.	Coordinator / PI	S12–S16

3.2 Identifiers

- **Master ID** identifies an organisation: MID-`<province code>-<sequence>`, e.g. MID-HA-000001.
- **Sample ID** identifies a case (an organisation's place in the sample): SID-`<year>-<sequence>`, e.g. SID-2026-000001.
- **KII ID** (KII-0001) and **DOC ID** (DOC-0001) identify interview and document records.
- All identifiers are generated by the system, can never be typed or edited, and are never reused. They are the link between the portal and KoboToolbox.

3.3 Sample, strata and Reserves

Organisations are stratified by **Province × Actor family × Size class**. Entity type and value chain are descriptive only. Each Main case is paired with one **Reserve** in the same stratum. A Reserve starts **LOCKED** and cannot be invited. It can be activated only when its Main case has dropped out (S12–S15), with one of five authorised reasons — Ineligible, Inactive, Duplicate, Refusal, Nonresponse exhausted — and a written evidence note. The portal enforces the lock itself, not just the screens.

3.4 Workflow statuses (S00–S16)

Every Main case has exactly one status. Statuses S05–S10 follow real events automatically; the rest are set by bulk verification or by an individual decision. Invalid jumps are refused and the attempt is audited.

Code	Status	Meaning
S00	Selected Main	The case is in the Main-400 sample. Starting point for every Main case.
S01	Verification required	The organisation's details are being checked.
S02	Organisation verified	The organisation exists, is active and is the right one.
S03	Eligible respondent identified	A knowledgeable senior person has been identified. Ready to invite.
S04	Invitation prepared	Optional manual step before sending.
S05	Invitation sent	Set automatically when an invitation is issued.
S06	Invitation opened	Set automatically when the respondent opens the link.
S07	Survey started	Set automatically when the respondent opens the questionnaire.
S08	Survey submitted	Set automatically when the questionnaire arrives from KoboToolbox.
S09	QA query	Set automatically when a QA reviewer re-queries the submission.
S10	QA passed	Set automatically when a QA reviewer accepts the submission.
S11	Completed	Final: the case is finished.
S12	Refused	Drop state: the organisation declined or withdrew.
S13	Nonresponse	Drop state: no response after every approved reminder was sent.
S14	Ineligible	Drop state: the organisation or respondent does not qualify.
S15	Duplicate / inactive	Drop state: duplicate record or organisation no longer operating.
S16	Reserve eligible for activation	The matched Reserve may now be activated to replace this case.

3.5 Invitations

- Each invitation is a random personal link plus an 8-character manual code, valid for **14 days**.
- Only a scrambled fingerprint is stored, so the link is shown once to the person issuing it and never again.
- Issuing a new invitation for a case immediately stops every earlier link for that case that has not yet been submitted. **Revoke** stops a link without replacing it.
- The invitation screen writes the invitation for WhatsApp, SMS and email, each with the link, expiry, manual code and study contact details. **Send via WhatsApp** and **Send by SMS** open the respondent's

own chat or messages app, **Email from study address** emails it from abffst.research@gmail.com, and **Copy message** covers any other channel.

- A locked Reserve can never be invited.

3.6 Eligibility and consent (the gates)

Before the questionnaire can open, the portal requires both a **passed eligibility check** (the person holds a senior, knowledgeable role) and **given participation consent** recorded against the Participant Information Sheet version shown. These checks are enforced on the server, so they cannot be bypassed by skipping a screen. Booking a researcher call also requires consent. Someone who is not eligible is thanked and no answers are recorded.

3.7 PROIT — pre-interview profiling, with AI research

For the questionnaire and the KIIs alike, an AI searches public sources for the organisation and the respondent's published professional role and proposes background facts, each with a source and a quote. A researcher accepts, edits or rejects every one, and a second person locks the profile. During and after the interview, the **Interview sheet** records whether the respondent confirmed, corrected or could not confirm each fact, and a coordinator reconciles the corrected ones. The case does not count as complete (QA accept; KII coding complete) until the profile is reconciled or a deviation is recorded. When it is, the portal sends the finished profile to KoboToolbox (the PROIT Interview Profile form), so the facts, the respondent's answers and the reconciled values are held there beside the interview itself. Only public, professional and organisational facts are ever recorded: the server removes anything private and any source the search did not actually return.

Researchers may record publicly available background facts about an organisation before contact, each with a source, date, confidence and authority tier, and a second researcher locks the profile. The respondent then confirms or corrects those facts instead of answering from zero, and can skip the step. The documentary value, the respondent's answer and the reconciled value are kept separately. PROIT never pre-fills, skips or infers any frozen scale item.

3.8 KoboToolbox integration

Form	Linked to	Used by
Main Study Questionnaire	Sample ID (hidden field set by the portal)	Respondents; phone/WhatsApp/face-to-face RAs
Main Study KII Guide	KII ID	KII RA
Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool	DOC ID	Documentary RA

- When a respondent starts the questionnaire, the portal opens the KoboToolbox web form with the Master ID, Sample ID, administration mode, role category and a **signed** reference to the invitation. No KoboToolbox account is needed.

- When a form is submitted, KoboToolbox notifies the portal within seconds, and the portal also checks KoboToolbox every 15 minutes by day and hourly overnight, so nothing is missed. **Sync now** on the QA Queue runs a check immediately.
- Each submission is matched to its case. A submission that does not carry the portal's signature (for example someone using the public form link directly) or that names an unknown Sample ID is **set aside and audited**, never guessed.
- If a submission is edited in KoboToolbox, the portal notices the change and returns it to QA review. Edits never create duplicates.
- The KII Guide and the Document Analysis Tool are synchronised the same way: the portal keeps its own copy of every submission of all three forms and shows on **Form PDFs** whether it matches KoboToolbox. A completed KII Guide marks that interview's coding COMPLETE; a document coding deleted in KoboToolbox unlocks the document.
- Full answers are stored privately on the server, never in a web-accessible folder, and are included in backups.
- Completed forms can be downloaded as readable PDFs, emailed, and (PI only) exported in full for analysis. The portal keeps its own synchronised copy of all three KoboToolbox forms, and shows whether it matches KoboToolbox.

3.9 Quality assurance

Every questionnaire is checked automatically when it arrives, then decided by a person. Nothing reaches **QA passed** without a human **Accept** and a note.

Rule	Setting (approved 15 Sep 2026)	Type
Required answers present	65 required fields from the live questionnaire	Hard stop
Minimum plausible duration	5 minutes	Soft flag
Maximum plausible duration	90 minutes	Soft flag
Duplicate organisation	Another submission for the same organisation within 24 hours	Soft flag
Administration mode balance	Alert when one mode exceeds 70% (shown in Reports)	Monitoring

Each triggered rule opens a **QA exception** that someone is assigned to, works and closes with a note. A **Re-query** moves the case to S09; an **Accept** to S10.

3.10 Reminders and nonresponse

For invited cases with no submission, the approved **Day 2 reminder** and **Day 7 final routine attempt** fall due and appear on **Follow-ups**, with the message and a one-tap WhatsApp link. A person sends each one and marks it sent. A case can become **S13 Nonresponse** only after every reminder has actually been recorded as sent; until then it is never treated as exhausted. Automatic sending through the WhatsApp Business Platform can be added later without changing this process.

3.11 Withdrawal

A single **Record withdrawal** action records the WITHDRAWN consent, revokes the invitation, stops reminders, moves the case to S12 where allowed, erases the phone, WhatsApp, email and gatekeeper contact, and audits the action. Answers already submitted are kept for the audit trail but never analysed (PI decision, 15 September 2026): they are left out of the analysis export and marked as withdrawn in the operational export and the PI's KoboToolbox downloads.

3.12 The KII and documentary strands

- **KII records** move PROSPECT → INVITED → SCHEDULED → COMPLETED (or DECLINED / NO_SHOW). Participation consent and recording consent are captured separately; a recorded interview cannot be completed without recording consent. Once participation consent is recorded, **Continue this interview** opens the KoboToolbox KII Guide with the KII ID filled in; the link is withheld until then and never carries the participant's name. Transcript and coding progress are tracked on the record.
- **Document records** need an authenticity assessment (Verified or Disputed) before they can be Included; an interpretive memo records reasoning. A document is best created by uploading it (**Quick add**): the AI reads the file, fills in the record's details and drafts the coding form, and a person reviews it. The source file is attached to the record (and can be removed if the wrong one was uploaded). Coding happens in the KoboToolbox Document Analysis Tool: **Code this document** opens it with the DOC ID filled in, and **Auto-fill** has AI draft the whole form from the source file for a Documentary RA to review, edit and submit. A PDF over 100 pages is coded by page range (for example one chapter) or read whole in parts and combined into one draft. The AI never submits on its own, and every draft is audited.

3.13 Monitoring, reports and exports

- **Dashboards** give live counts: Executive, Sampling, Contact, QA, KII/Documents, Cost.
- **Reports** give analytics with charts and table views over 7, 30, 90 days or all time.
- **Exports**: a de-identified analysis CSV, a full operational CSV (PI only), and for each KoboToolbox form a complete Excel workbook and a ZIP of PDFs (PI only).

3.14 Security and privacy controls

Control	How it works
Role-based access	Each account has one of eight roles. The server checks the role on every request; the menu shows only permitted screens. Contact RAs see only their assigned cases.
Secure sign-in	Encrypted connection (HTTPS). Session tokens are kept in secure browser cookies that page scripts cannot read. Sign-in attempts are rate-limited.
Personal links	Random, expiring, stored only as fingerprints; superseded or revoked links stop working.
Signed questionnaire links	Only submissions launched from the portal are matched to a case.
Private answers	KoboToolbox answers are stored outside anything the web server publishes.
Separation of identity and answers	Dashboards, Reports and the analysis export never contain names or contact details.

Control	How it works
Audit trail	Every sensitive action — consent, invitations, status changes, reserve activation, QA decisions, exports, emails, withdrawals — is recorded with the user and time.
Backups	Every 4 hours on the server; encrypted offsite copy to Google Drive once enabled.

4. Getting started

Signing in

1. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login> in any modern browser (Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari), on a computer, tablet or phone.
2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then select **Sign in**.

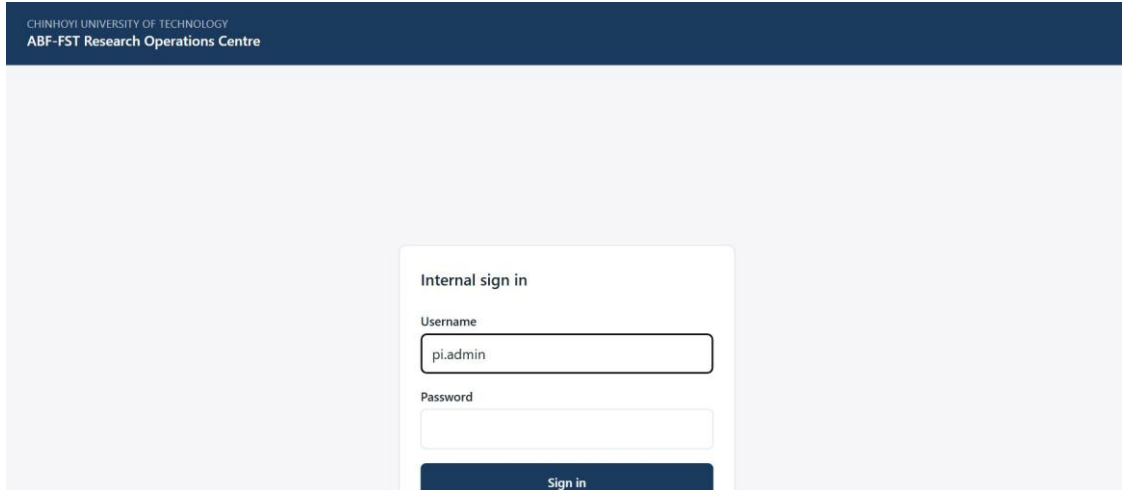
The image shows a web browser window displaying the internal sign-in page. At the top, a dark blue header contains the text 'CHINGHOY UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY' and 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre'. Below the header, the main content area is light gray. In the center, there is a white box titled 'Internal sign in'. Inside this box, there are two input fields: 'Username' with the text 'pi.admin' and 'Password' which is empty. Below the password field is a dark blue button labeled 'Sign in'.

Figure 1. The sign-in screen for all internal staff.

3. You arrive on your start screen: **your role's start screen**. The bar across the top lists only the screens your role (for example Contact RA) can open.

Accounts

There is no self-registration. The PI / System Admin creates every account and sets its role. Ask the PI if you need an account, a different role, or a password reset.

Finding your way around

- The **top bar** shows your username and role, and the screens you can use. It is not a full menu with some items greyed out: anything absent is simply not part of your role.
- Most screens have a **← Back to ...** link at the top that returns you to the screen you came from.
- Registers show **20 rows per page** to begin with. At the foot of the list, **Show** lets you choose 10, 20, 50, 100 or 200 rows per page (the portal remembers your choice), and the page numbers, **Previous**, **Next** and the double arrows take you to any page. The **Search** box above the list narrows it.
- **Change password** (top right) lets you set a new password at any time. Choose a long password you do not use anywhere else.
- **Sign out** (top right) ends your session. Always sign out on a shared or public computer.
- If you are inactive for a while you may be asked to sign in again. This protects research data on unattended devices.

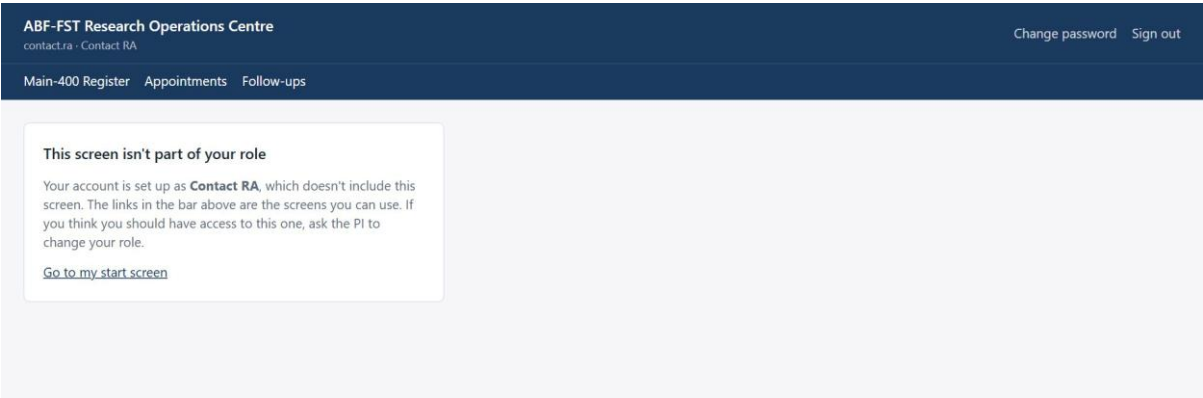


Figure 2. Opening a screen outside your role (for example from an old bookmark) shows this card instead of the screen.

Changing your password

- 1. Select **Change password** in the top right corner.
- 2. Enter your **Current password**, then the **New password** twice, and select **Change password**.

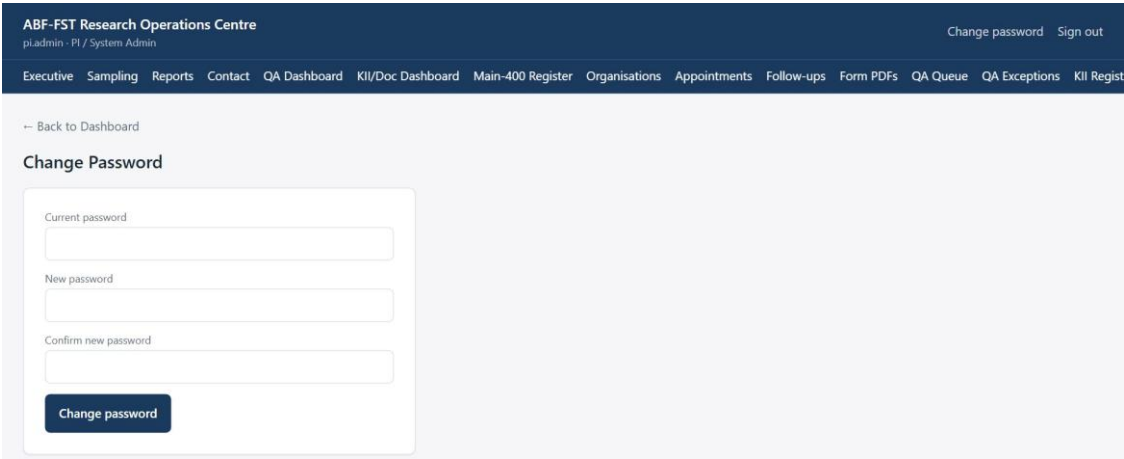


Figure 3. Change Password screen.

- 3. Use the new password next time you sign in. If you have forgotten your password, ask the PI to reset it.

5. Roles and permissions

Every account has exactly one role. The role decides which screens appear and what can be changed. The three research-assistant roles for QA, KII and documents are deliberately separate: someone who needs to work across them should be given the Field Coordinator role, not a second account.

Role	Screens	Starts on
PI / System Admin	All 19 screens, including the Audit Log and every export	Executive Dashboard
Field / Digital Coordinator	18 screens — everything except the Audit Log. No full operational export and no KoboToolbox data download	Executive Dashboard
Contact RA	Main-400 Register, Appointments, Follow-ups — only the cases assigned to you	Main-400 Register
QUAN/Kobo QA RA	QA Dashboard, Form PDFs (questionnaire), QA Queue, QA Exceptions	QA Dashboard
KII RA	KII/Doc Dashboard, Form PDFs (KII Guide), KII Register	KII/Doc Dashboard
Documentary RA	KII/Doc Dashboard, Form PDFs (Document Analysis Tool), Documents	KII/Doc Dashboard
Data Analyst	Executive, Sampling, Reports, Contact and KII/Doc dashboards, Cost, Export (de-identified only). Read-only	Executive Dashboard
Supervisor (read-only)	17 screens — everything except the Audit Log and Export. Read-only	Executive Dashboard

5.1 Who can do what

Action	PI	FC	Contact RA	QA RA	KII RA	Doc RA	Analyst	Supervisor
View dashboards & Reports	✓	✓	—	QA only	KII/Doc	KII/Doc	✓	✓
Register organisations, pair Reserves, assign RAs	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	view
Bulk verification	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	—
Record respondents, invite, log contact	✓	✓	own cases	—	—	—	—	view
Send follow-ups	✓	✓	own cases	—	—	—	—	view
Record withdrawal	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	—
Activate Reserves	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	—	view
QA decisions & exceptions	✓	✓	—	✓	—	—	—	view
KII records	✓	✓	—	—	✓	—	—	view

Action	PI	FC	Contact RA	QA RA	KII RA	Doc RA	Analyst	Supervisor
Document records	✓	✓	—	—	—	✓	—	view
Form PDFs (own form)	all	all	—	Questionnaire	KII Guide	Doc Tool	—	view all
Log costs	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	view	view
Analysis export	✓	✓	—	—	—	—	✓	—
Operational export, KoboToolbox data, Audit Log	✓	—	—	—	—	—	—	—

6. Screen reference

Every screen in the Research Operations Centre, in menu order.

6.1 Executive, Sampling and Contact dashboards

Dashboards are for monitoring; nothing on them changes data. Figures refresh whenever the screen is opened.

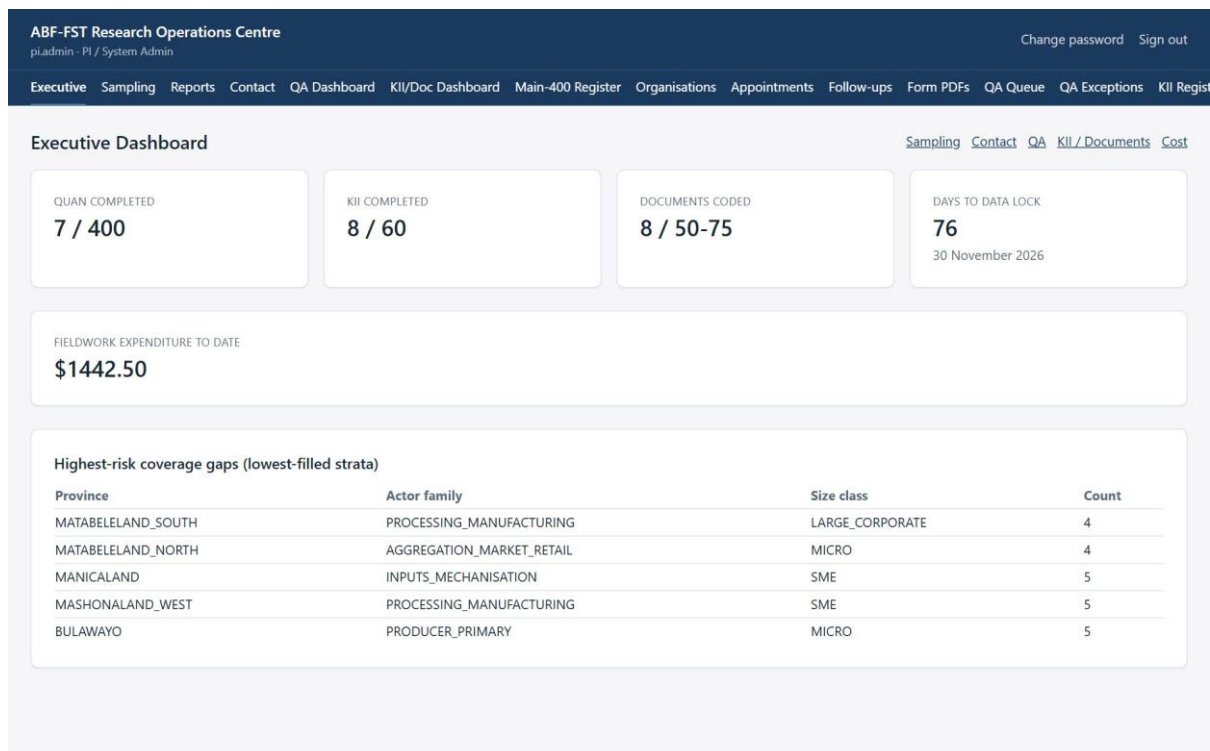


Figure 4. Executive Dashboard: completions against the 400 / 60 / 50–75 targets, days to data lock, spend, and the lowest-filled strata.

Dashboard	What it tells you	Use it to
Executive	QUAN completed out of 400, KII completed out of 60, documents coded against 50–75, days to the 30 November 2026 data lock, spend to date, lowest-filled strata.	See overall progress and where fieldwork attention is most needed.
Sampling	Main cases by province, verified/total by stratum, Reserve activations by reason.	Check the design stays balanced across strata.
Contact	Organisations verified, eligible respondents identified, invitations sent and opened, upcoming appointments, refusals, unreachable cases.	Track outreach and spot stalled contact.
QA Dashboard	Submissions today and in total, the open QA queue, decisions recorded, completions by administration mode.	Keep the QA backlog under control.
KII/Doc Dashboard	KII completed against 60; KIIs by status; documents by type and QA status.	Track the qualitative and documentary strands.

Targets versus records

The registers hold more records than the targets (for example 90 KII records for 60 completed interviews). The surplus is reserve depth for non-response, not extra work.

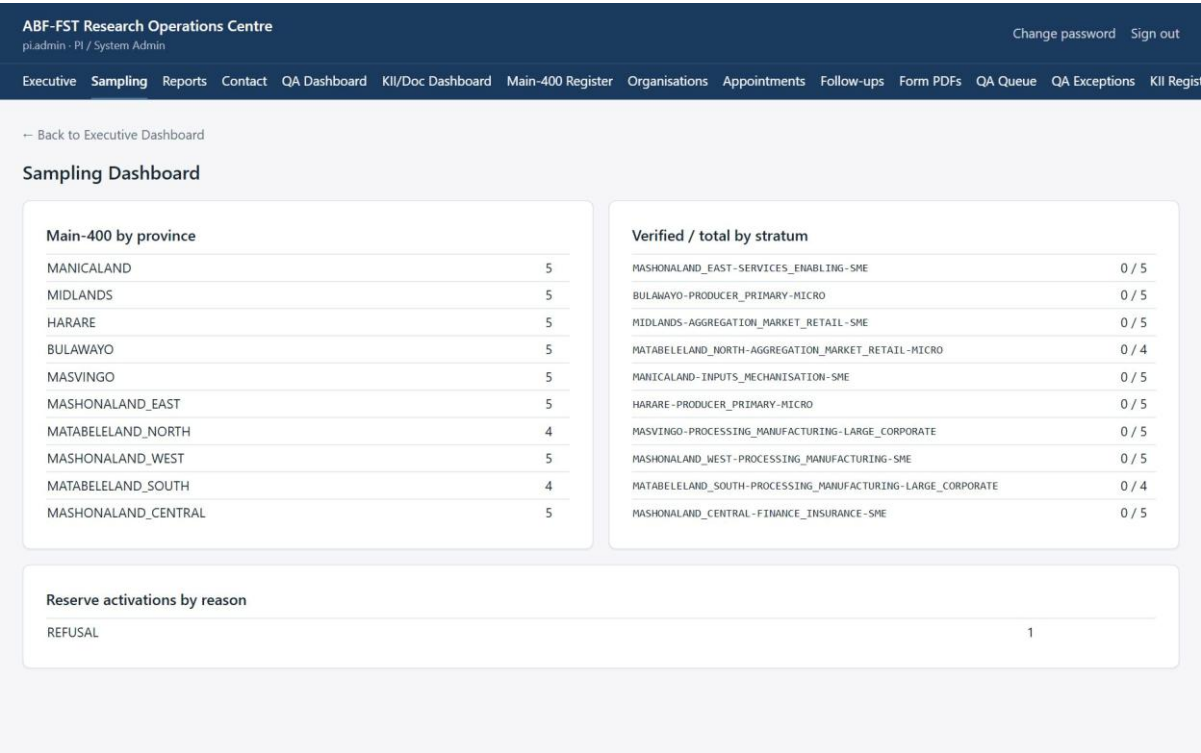


Figure 5. Sampling Dashboard.

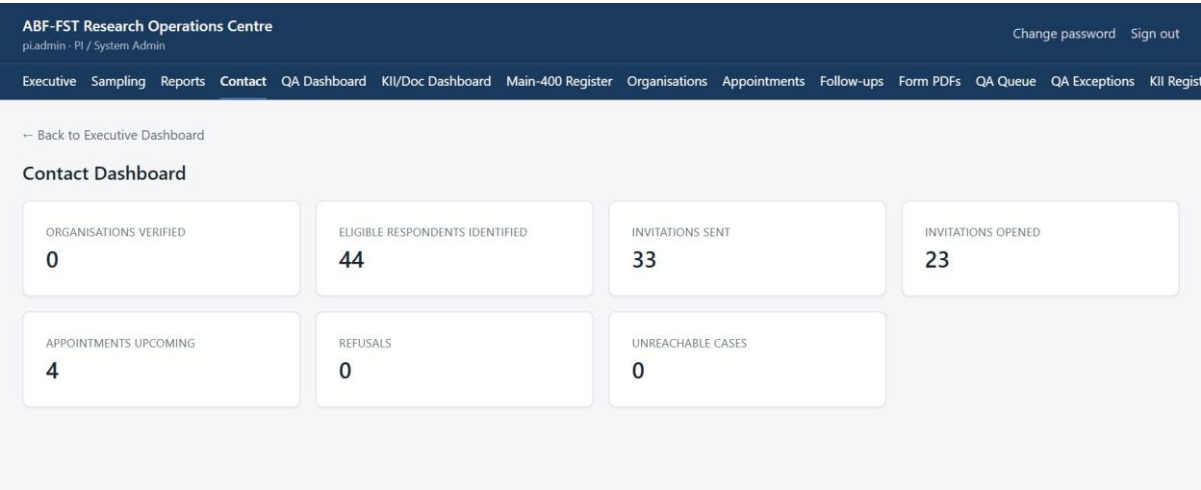


Figure 6. Contact Dashboard.

6.2 Reports

Fieldwork analytics for the PI, Field Coordinator, Analyst and Supervisor. See procedure 7.2.

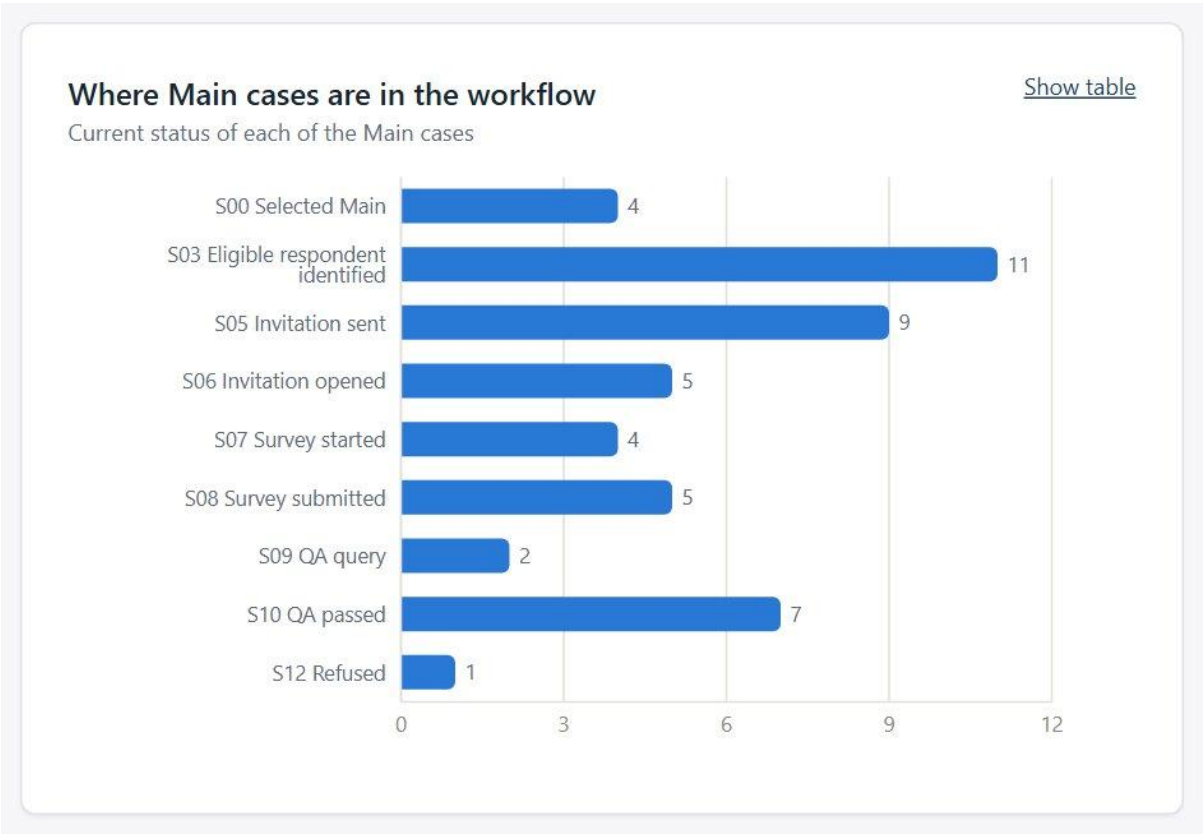


Figure 7. Where Main cases are in the workflow.

6.3 QA Dashboard

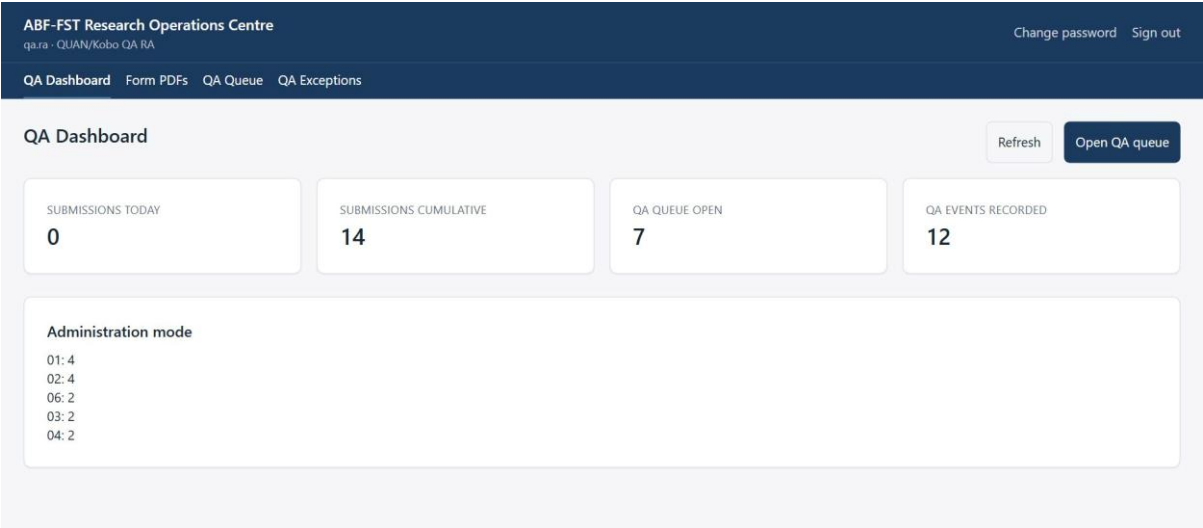


Figure 8. QA Dashboard with Refresh and Open QA queue.

6.4 KII/Doc Dashboard

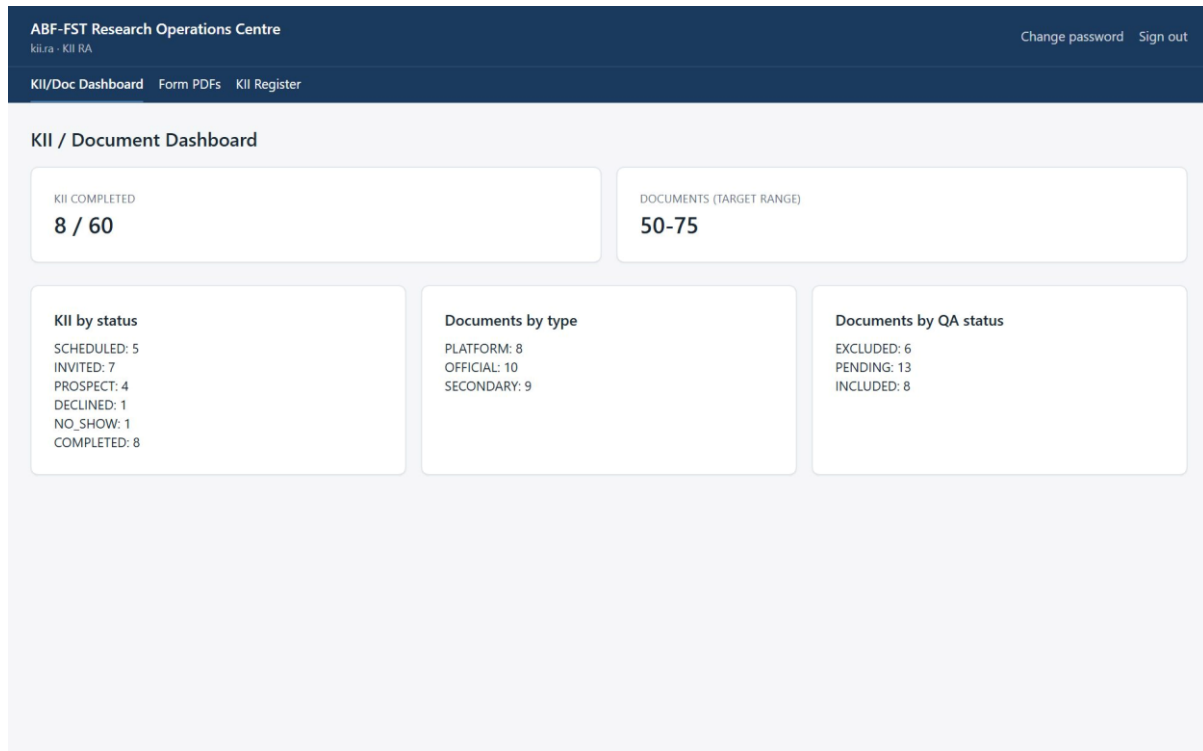


Figure 9. KII / Document Dashboard.

6.5 Main-400 Register

Every Main case (or, with **Sample type** → **Reserve**, every Reserve), with Sample ID, Master ID, organisation and status. Search by Sample ID, Master ID or name. **View** opens the case page. The PI and Field Coordinator also see **Register organisation** and the bulk verification tool.

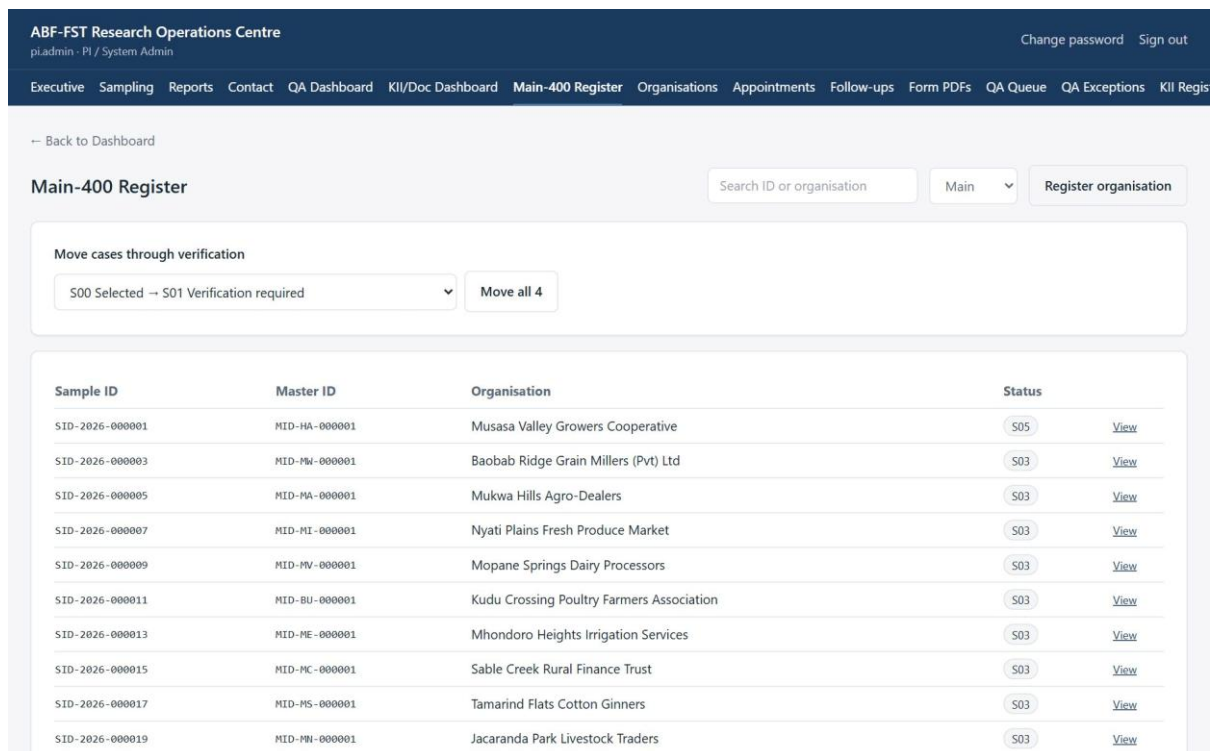


Figure 10. Main-400 Register.

6.6 Case page

The working screen for one organisation. From top to bottom:

Panel	Purpose
Case summary	Organisation, Sample ID, Master ID, stratum, type and status.
Assigned Contact RA	Who owns the case (PI/FC can change it).
Matched Reserve case	The Reserve that would replace it.
Pre-Interview Profile (PROIT)	Background facts with sources, researched by AI from public sources for you to accept or reject; lock for use with the respondent. Once locked, the Interview sheet.
Respondents and contact details	People at the organisation, their role, eligibility and contact details.
Invitations	Issue links and send them with a ready-written message by WhatsApp, SMS or email (from the study address or your own mail app); reissue and revoke; invitation history.
Completed questionnaire	The KoboToolbox submission(s) for this case, with Download PDF.
Record a withdrawal	One action for a participant who withdraws (PI/FC).
Advance workflow status	Allowed manual status changes.
Contact timeline	Every contact attempt; log a new one.

The screenshot shows the top section of a case page in the ABF-FST Research Operations Centre. The header includes the organization name, user role (pi.admin - PI / System Admin), and links for 'Change password' and 'Sign out'. A navigation bar lists various system modules. The main content area features a 'Back to Main-400 Register' link and several panels:

- Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative**: A summary panel showing key identifiers: Sample ID (SID-2026-000001), Master ID (MID-HA-000001), Stratum (HARARE-PRODUCER_PRIMARY-MICRO), Type (MAIN), and Status (S05).
- Assigned Contact RA**: A panel with a dropdown menu showing 'contact.ra' and the text 'Currently: contact.ra'.
- Matched Reserve case**: A panel with a note about reserve activation and a dropdown menu showing 'SID-2026-000002 — Sable Creek Growers Cooperative' and 'Currently: SID-2026-000002 — Sable Creek Growers Cooperative'.
- Pre-Interview Profile (PROIT)**: A panel with a note stating 'No background research has been started for this case yet. Creating one lets you record what's already publicly known about the organisation/respondent, with a source for each fact, before'.

Figure 11. Top of a case page.

The screenshot shows the 'Completed questionnaire' panel. It displays the submission date and time: 'Submitted 9/14/2026, 11:12:40 AM (web form)'. A 'Download PDF' button is located in the bottom right corner of the panel.

Figure 12. Completed questionnaire panel on a QA-passed case.

6.7 Organisations

Register a new organisation and create its sample case; search the list of registered organisations. See procedure 7.3.

6.8 Appointments

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre

piadmin · PI / System Admin

Change passwordSign out

Executive

Sampling

Reports

Contact

QA Dashboard

KII/Doc Dashboard

Main-400 Register

Organisations

Appointments

Follow-ups

Form PDFs

QA Queue

QA Exceptions

KII Register

← Back to Dashboard

Appointment Queue

All statuses

Case / informant	Scheduled for	Mode	Status	Actions
SID-2026-000045 Highveld Meadow Agro-Dealers	9/13/2026, 7:15:00 PM	PHONE	COMPLETED	No further action
SID-2026-000051 Baobab Ridge Poultry Farmers Association	9/14/2026, 7:15:00 PM	FACE_TO_FACE	MISSED	No further action
SID-2026-000025 Granite Kopje Agro-Dealers	9/16/2026, 9:15:00 PM	PHONE	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000029 Red Earth Dairy Processors	9/18/2026, 12:15:00 AM	WHATSAPP_VOICE	CONFIRMED	COMPLETED MISSED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000087 Silver Stream Fresh Produce Market	9/18/2026, 10:00:00 AM	PHONE	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000041 Acacia Downs Growers Cooperative	9/18/2026, 7:15:00 PM	ZOOM	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED

Figure 13. Appointment Queue.

6.9 Follow-ups

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre					Change password	Sign out
piadmin · PI / System Admin						
Executive Sampling Reports Contact QA Dashboard KII/Doc Dashboard Main-400 Register Organisations Appointments Follow-ups Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions KII Register						
← Back to Main-400 Register						
Follow-ups due Approved reminders for invited cases that haven't responded yet. Open WhatsApp, send the message, then mark it sent.						
SID-2026-000039 Silver Stream Livestock Traders Day 7 final routine attempt - invited 9/7/2026 - Munashe Demo-Sibanda - no number on file Hello, this is a final reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation. If you would still like to take part, please use the link you were sent. Thank you. Open WhatsApp (choose contact) Mark as sent						
SID-2026-000029 Red Earth Dairy Processors Day 7 final routine attempt - invited 9/8/2026 - Nokuthula Demo-Zvobgo - no number on file Hello, this is a final reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation. If you would still like to take part, please use the link you were sent. Thank you. Open WhatsApp (choose contact) Mark as sent						
SID-2026-000045 Highveld Meadow Agro-Dealers Day 2 reminder - invited 9/11/2026 - Farai Demo-Zvobgo - +263 77 000 1022 Hello, this is a reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation sent to your organisation. Please use the link you were sent to take part, or reply here if you have questions.						

Figure 14. Follow-ups due.

6.10 Form PDFs

Completed KoboToolbox forms for your role's form, newest first. The PI, Field Coordinator and Supervisor choose the form from **Form**. A panel at the top shows whether the portal and KoboToolbox hold the same number of submissions, and **Sync now** brings the portal's copy level. The PI also has **Excel workbook** and **All as PDFs (ZIP)** buttons here.

The screenshot shows the 'Completed forms' section of the ABF-FST Research Operations Centre portal. The page header includes the portal name and navigation links. The main content area shows a list of three completed forms, each with a unique ID, a status indicator (✓ saved in portal), and submission details. Each form entry has three buttons: 'Download PDF', 'Email to me', and 'Email to respondent'. Above the list, there are buttons for 'Sync now', 'Excel workbook', and 'All as PDFs (ZIP)'. The page also displays a 'Showing 1 to 3 of 3 submissions' status and a pagination control set to '20 per page'.

Figure 15. Completed form PDFs.

6.11 QA Queue and QA Exceptions

See procedures 7.13 and 7.14.

6.12 KII Register and KII record

See procedure 7.16.

6.13 Documents and document record

See procedure 7.17.

6.14 Reserve Activation, Cost, Audit Log, Export, Change password

See procedures 7.12, 7.18, 7.20, 7.19 and chapter 4.

7. Procedures, step by step

Each procedure lists who may do it. Screens you cannot open are not in your menu.

7.1 Dashboards (all monitoring roles)

Open any dashboard from the top bar; see 6.1.

7.2 Reports (PI, FC, Analyst, Supervisor)

1. Select **Reports** in the top bar.

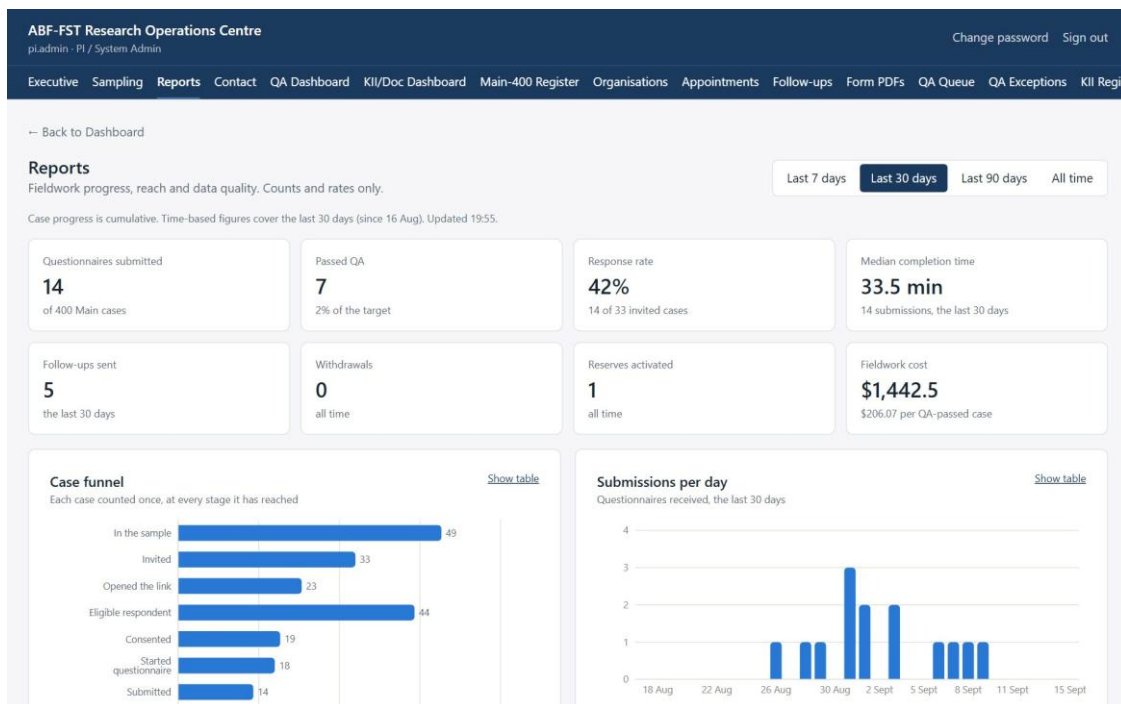


Figure 16. Reports: headline figures for the chosen period.

2. Choose the period with **Last 7 days**, **Last 30 days**, **Last 90 days** or **All time**. Case progress (the funnel and workflow) is always cumulative; time-based figures such as submissions per day follow the period.
3. Read the headline cards: questionnaires submitted, passed QA, response rate (submitted ÷ invited), median completion time, follow-ups sent, withdrawals, Reserves activated, and fieldwork cost per QA-passed case.

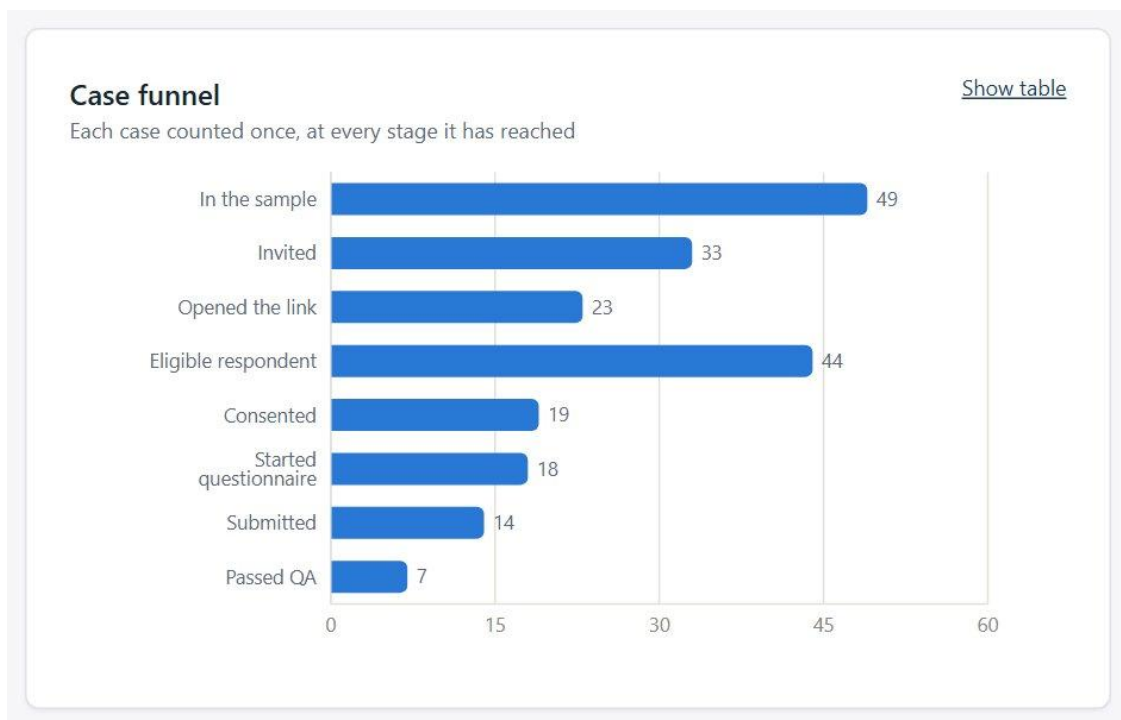


Figure 17. Case funnel: each case counted once at every stage it has reached.

4. Select **Show table** on any chart to see the exact numbers, for example to copy them into a progress report.

Case funnel [Show chart](#)

Each case counted once, at every stage it has reached

Stage	Cases
In the sample	49
Invited	33
Opened the link	23
Eligible respondent	44
Consented	19
Started questionnaire	18
Submitted	14
Passed QA	7

Figure 18. The same chart as a table.

5. Use **Coverage** to see, by province, organisation type and size, what share of cases have been invited and have submitted. Short bars show where contact effort should go next.

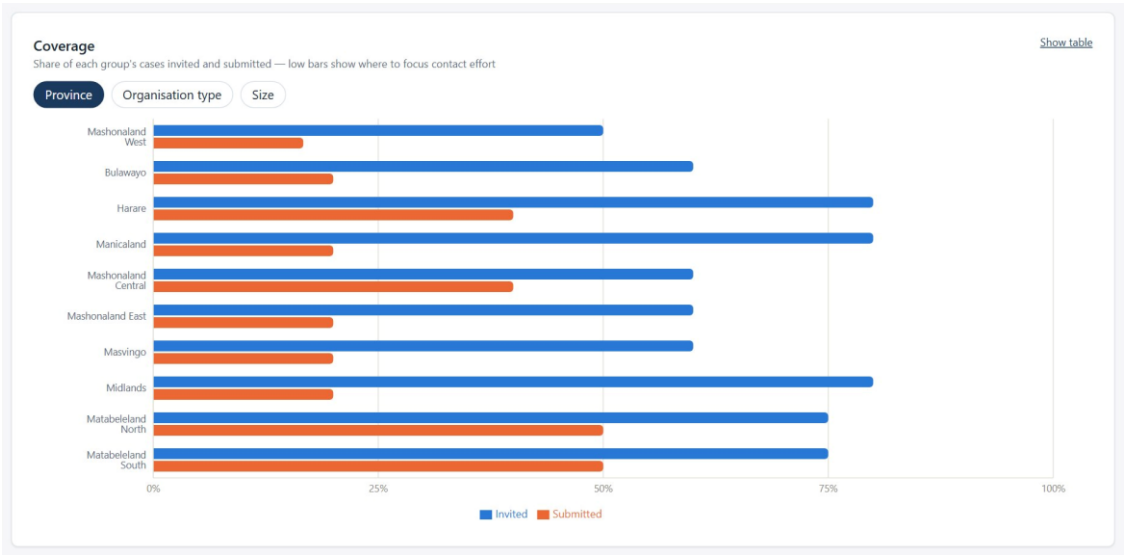


Figure 19. Coverage by group.

- 6. Check **How questionnaires were completed**. If one administration mode dominates (more than 70% once at least 10 questionnaires are in), the chart shows an imbalance alert so the team can review the mix.



Figure 20. Administration modes.

- 7. Review **Time to complete the questionnaire** and **QA outcomes**. Very short or very long completions are what the QA duration rules flag.

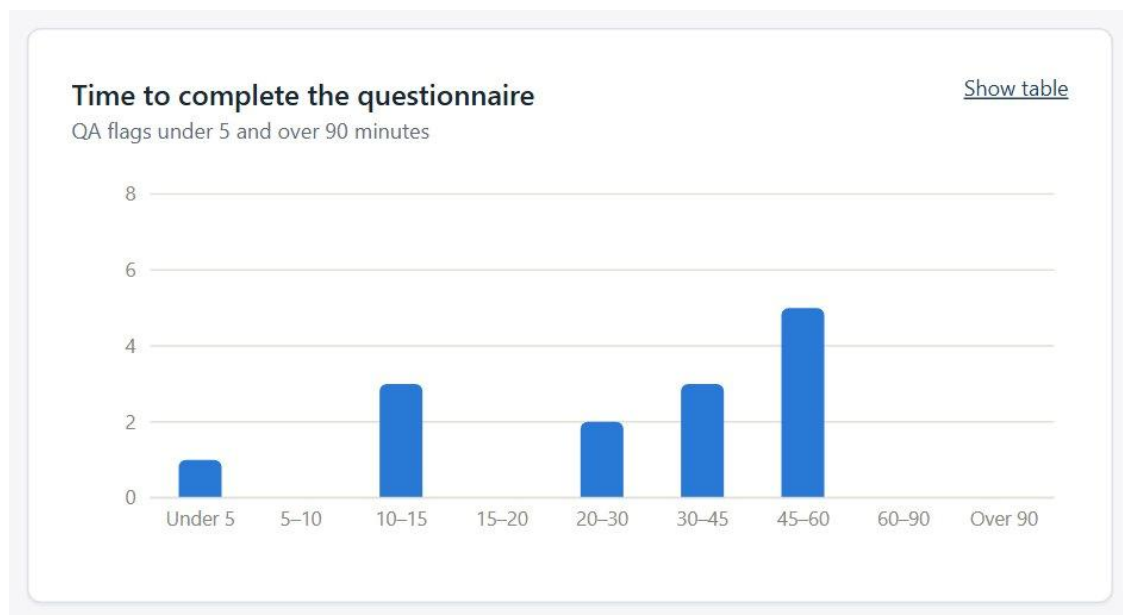


Figure 21. Completion-time distribution.

Reports show counts and rates only — never names or answers — so they are safe to discuss with supervisors.

7.3 Registering an organisation (PI, FC)

The approved registers are already loaded. Use this only for a late addition, replacement or correction.

1. Select **Organisations** in the top bar.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
pladmin - PI / System Admin [Change password](#) [Sign out](#)

[Executive](#) [Sampling](#) [Reports](#) [Contact](#) [QA Dashboard](#) [KII/Doc Dashboard](#) [Main-400 Register](#) **[Organisations](#)** [Appointments](#) [Follow-ups](#) [Form PDFs](#) [QA Queue](#) [QA Exceptions](#) [KII Register](#)

[← Back to Dashboard](#)

Register Organisation

New organisation

Master_ID is generated automatically from the province once saved.

Name

District

Province

Entity type

Actor family

Value chain

Size class

[Register organisation](#)

Registered organisations

Master ID	Name	Province	Verification
MID-HV-000009	Acacia Downs Dairy Processors	MASVINGO	UNVERIFIED Create sample case

Figure 22. Register Organisation: the form (top) and the list of registered organisations (below).

2. Complete **Name**, **District**, **Province**, **Entity type**, **Actor family**, **Value chain** and **Size class**. Province, actor family and size class decide the stratum, so check them carefully.
3. Select **Register organisation**. The Master ID (e.g. MID-HA-000012) is generated automatically.

- When offered, choose **Main** or **Reserve** and select **Create sample case**. The Sample ID is generated and the new case page opens. You can also create the case later from the organisation's row in the list.
- For a Main case, register its Reserve counterpart in the **same province, actor family and size class**, then pair them (next procedure).

7.4 Pairing a Reserve and assigning a Contact RA (PI, FC)

- Open the Main case (**Main-400 Register → View**).
- In **Assigned Contact RA**, choose the RA from the list. The change saves straight away and shows **Currently: <name>**. That RA now sees the case; other Contact RAs do not.

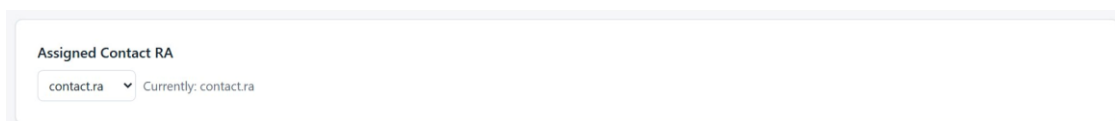


Figure 23. Assigned Contact RA.

- In **Matched Reserve case**, choose the Reserve. Only locked Reserves not already paired are offered, same-stratum ones first. A cross-stratum choice is allowed but flagged in the audit log.

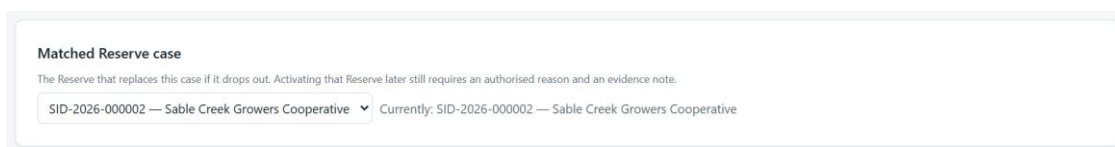


Figure 24. Matched Reserve case.

7.5 Bulk verification to S03 (PI, FC)

Every Main case must reach **S03 Eligible respondent identified** before it is invited, otherwise its status will not follow the respondent and no reminders are offered. Verification (S00 → S01 → S02 → S03) can be done for all cases at a step at once.

- Open **Main-400 Register**.
- In **Move cases through verification**, choose the step, for example **S00 Selected → S01 Verification required**. The button shows how many Main cases are at that step, e.g. **Move all 48**.

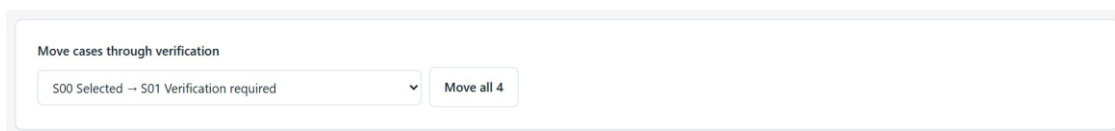


Figure 25. The bulk verification tool on the register.

- Select the button and confirm. Each case is moved individually and each move is written to the audit log under your name.
- Repeat for **S01 → S02** and **S02 → S03**.

Only verification is bulk

Statuses from S04 onwards follow real events (invitation sent, link opened, questionnaire submitted, QA decision) or an individual decision on the case page. They are never changed in bulk.

7.6 Recording respondents and contact details (PI, FC, Contact RA)

Invitations and reminders need a phone or WhatsApp number. Record the eligible person as soon as they are identified.

1. Open the case (**Main-400 Register → View**) and find **Respondents and contact details**.
2. Select **Add a person**. Enter **Full name**, **Phone**, **WhatsApp number**, **Email**, and a **Gatekeeper name** and **Gatekeeper contact** if you reach the person through a PA or receptionist.

Respondents and contact details

Full name Phone

WhatsApp number Email

Gatekeeper name Gatekeeper contact

Role Eligibility

Tendai Demo-Moyo
CEO/MD - Eligible
Phone +263 77 000 1000 · WhatsApp +263 77 000 1000 · respondent0@example.org

Figure 26. Adding a person to a case.

3. Choose their **role** and the eligibility decision: **Eligible (I screened them)**, **Not eligible**, or **Not yet screened**.
4. Select **Save person**. To correct details later, select **Edit** beside the person, change the fields, then **Save changes**.
5. Write WhatsApp numbers in international form, e.g. **+263 77 123 4567**, so the WhatsApp buttons open the right chat.

Who is eligible?

Owner or founder, CEO or managing director, finance/credit/risk, operations, strategy/business development, supply chain/commercial, or another senior manager who can answer for the organisation. Anyone else should nominate the right person.

7.7 Sending an invitation (PI, FC, Contact RA)

1. Open the case. Check the status is **S03** and a respondent with a number is recorded.
2. In **Invitations**, leave **Channel** as **WHATSAPP** (or choose EMAIL, SMS, PRINTED_CODE or QR to record how it was delivered) and **Wave** as **1**. Select **Send invitation**.

Invitations

Channel Wave

Wave	Channel	Status	Issued	Actions
1	WHATSAPP	SENT	9/15/2026	Revoke

Figure 27. Invitations panel before sending, with the history of earlier invitations.

- The personal link and 8-character manual code appear **once**, with the invitation already written for each channel. Choose **WhatsApp message**, **SMS message** or **Email message** to see exactly what will be sent: the personal link, its expiry date, the manual code and the study contact line.

Figure 28. The link, manual code and ready-written messages are shown once, with a send button for each channel.

- Send it on the channel that suits the respondent:
 - Send via WhatsApp** opens that respondent's chat (their WhatsApp number, or phone number if none) with the message ready. Check you are on the study WhatsApp number, then press Send.
 - Send by SMS** opens the phone's messages app addressed to the respondent, with the shorter SMS message. Use it on a phone.
 - Email from study address** sends the email from abfst.research@gmail.com to the respondent's email on file; replies go to the study inbox. The email is recorded in the audit log.
 - Open in email app** opens the same email in your own mail program, if you need to add something first.
 - Copy message** copies the message shown, for any other channel.
- If a button says no number or email is on file, add it under **Respondents and contact details**, then send a new invitation.
- The case moves to **S05 Invitation sent** automatically. Log the attempt in **Contact timeline** (see Logging a contact attempt).

The link is shown only once

The portal stores only a scrambled fingerprint of the link, so nobody can display it again. If you close the page before sending, select **Send new invitation (replaces current)**: this issues a fresh link and the old one stops working immediately.

Links are valid for **14 days**. Each link belongs to one organisation; never forward one respondent's link to another organisation.

Revoking an invitation

In the invitation history, select **Revoke** on an open invitation (for example, if it was sent to the wrong number). The link stops working at once. Issue a new one if the case should still be invited.

7.8 Logging a contact attempt (PI, FC, Contact RA)

Record **every** attempt, successful or not. The Contact Dashboard, Reports and any later replacement decision rely on it.

- On the case page, scroll to **Contact timeline** → **Log a contact attempt**.

The figure shows a 'Contact timeline' section with the text 'No contact events recorded yet.' Below this is a 'Log a contact attempt' section. It contains two dropdown menus: 'PHONE' and 'REACHED'. Below these is a text input field labeled 'Notes (optional)'. At the bottom of this section is a blue button labeled 'Log contact attempt'.

Figure 29. Contact timeline and the form for logging an attempt.

2. Choose the **channel** (WHATSAPP, EMAIL, PHONE, SMS, FACE_TO_FACE) and the **outcome** (REACHED, NO_ANSWER, WRONG_NUMBER, REFUSED, RESCHEDULED, COMPLETED).
3. Add a short, factual note (optional), e.g. "PA says MD travelling; call back Thursday". Do not record opinions about the person.
4. Select **Log contact attempt**. The entry appears at the top of the timeline with the date and time.

7.9 Sending follow-up reminders (PI, FC, Contact RA)

Approved reminders fall due on **Day 2** and **Day 7** after an invitation for respondents who have not yet submitted. Until automatic WhatsApp sending is connected, a person sends each one.

1. Select **Follow-ups**. Each card shows the case, organisation, which reminder is due, when the invitation went out, the respondent and their number, and the exact approved message.

The figure shows a screenshot of the 'Follow-ups' section in the ABF-FST Research Operations Centre. The header includes 'ABF-FST Research Operations Centre', 'contact.ra · Contact RA', and links for 'Change password' and 'Sign out'. Below the header is a navigation bar with 'Main-400 Register', 'Appointments', and 'Follow-ups'. A link '← Back to Main-400 Register' is visible. The main content area is titled 'Follow-ups due' and includes the instruction: 'Approved reminders for invited cases that haven't responded yet. Open WhatsApp, send the message, then mark it sent.' There are three cards, each representing a case. Each card shows a case ID (e.g., SID-2026-000039), the organisation name (e.g., Silver Stream Livestock Traders), the reminder type and date (e.g., Day 7 final routine attempt - invited 9/7/2026), and the contact details (e.g., Munashe Demo-Sibanda - no number on file). Each card contains a text box with the reminder message and two buttons: 'Open WhatsApp (choose contact)' and 'Mark as sent'.

Figure 30. Follow-ups due. Contact RAs see only their own cases.

2. Select **Open in WhatsApp**. WhatsApp opens with the message ready for that number; send it. If the card says **no number on file**, the button reads **Open WhatsApp (choose contact)** — pick the chat yourself, and add the number to the case afterwards.
3. Come back and select **Mark as sent**. The card disappears and the reminder is recorded under your name.

Mark as sent only after sending

A case can become **S13 Nonresponse** (and be replaced by its Reserve) only after every reminder has been recorded as sent. Marking a reminder you did not send could lead to an organisation being replaced without being contacted.

7.10 Managing appointments (PI, FC, Contact RA)

1. Select **Appointments**. Each row shows the case (Sample ID and organisation) or KII, the requested time, the mode (PHONE, WHATSAPP_VOICE, ZOOM, ...) and the status.

Case / informant	Scheduled for	Mode	Status	Actions
SID-2026-000045 Highveld Meadow Agro-Dealers	9/13/2026, 7:15:00 PM	PHONE	COMPLETED	No further action
SID-2026-000051 Baobab Ridge Poultry Farmers Association	9/14/2026, 7:15:00 PM	FACE_TO_FACE	MISSED	No further action
SID-2026-000025 Granite Kopje Agro-Dealers	9/16/2026, 9:15:00 PM	PHONE	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000029 Red Earth Dairy Processors	9/18/2026, 12:15:00 AM	WHATSAPP_VOICE	CONFIRMED	COMPLETED MISSED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000087 Silver Stream Fresh Produce Market	9/18/2026, 10:00:00 AM	PHONE	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED
SID-2026-000041 Acacia Downs Growers Cooperative	9/18/2026, 7:15:00 PM	ZOOM	REQUESTED	CONFIRMED CANCELLED

Figure 31. Appointment Queue.

2. Use **Filter by status** to show, for example, only **REQUESTED** appointments.
3. Contact the respondent to confirm, then select **CONFIRMED**.
4. After the session select **COMPLETED**, or **MISSED** if they did not attend, or **CANCELLED**. Only valid next steps are shown; a finished appointment shows **No further action**.

7.11 Assisted administration (RAs)

When the respondent prefers help, the researcher completes the questionnaire with them. The respondent must still hear the participant information and agree before any question is asked.

1. Agree a time. If the respondent booked through the portal, it is in **Appointments**.
2. At the start of the call, confirm the organisation and the person's role, read or summarise the Participant Information Sheet (v1.3) and ask for consent. Stop if they decline.
3. Open the respondent's personal invitation link on your device and go through the portal screens with them (organisation, role, information, consent), choosing the answers they give you.
4. Open the questionnaire from the portal so the case identifiers travel with the form, and complete it with the respondent. Never start the KoboToolbox form from a bookmark: a submission without the portal's link is set aside and not matched.
5. After submitting, log the contact attempt with outcome **COMPLETED**, and mark the appointment **COMPLETED**.

Code	Mode	What happens
01	Web self-administration	The respondent completes the questionnaire alone from the link.
02	WhatsApp link, self-completion	The link is sent by WhatsApp; the respondent completes it alone.
03	Telephone, interviewer-administered	A researcher calls and completes the form while the respondent answers.
04	WhatsApp call, interviewer-assisted	As 03, over a WhatsApp voice or video call.
05	Video call, interviewer-assisted	As 03, over Teams, Zoom or Google Meet.
06	Face to face	In person; the researcher operates the device.

7.12 Activating a Reserve (PI, FC)

A Reserve replaces its Main case only after the Main case reaches a drop state (S12 Refused, S13 Nonresponse, S14 Ineligible or S15 Duplicate/inactive) and there is evidence.

1. Select **Reserve Activation**. Every locked Reserve is listed with a search box.

The screenshot shows the 'Reserve Activation' page in the ABF-FST Research Operations Centre. At the top, there's a navigation bar with links like 'Executive', 'Sampling', 'Reports', 'Contact', 'QA Dashboard', etc. Below the navigation bar, there's a 'Back to Dashboard' link. The main content area is titled 'Reserve Activation' and features a search bar labeled 'Search ID or organisation'. Below the search bar, there are two reserve entries. The first entry is for 'Sable Creek Growers Cooperative' (SID-2026-000002). It has a dropdown menu for 'Select authorised reason' and a text area for 'Evidence note (required)'. Below these fields is a button labeled 'Activate this reserve'. The second entry is for 'Tamarind Flats Grain Millers (Pvt) Ltd' (SID-2026-000004) and is partially visible.

Figure 32. Reserve Activation.

2. Find the Reserve matched to the dropped Main case (the Main case page shows the pairing).
3. Choose the authorised reason: **Ineligible, Inactive, Duplicate, Refusal** or **Nonresponse exhausted**. There is deliberately no "other".
4. Write the **Evidence note (required)**, e.g. "MD declined by phone 12 Sep, logged in contact timeline".
5. Select **Activate this reserve**. The Reserve becomes invitable and is worked like any Main case, starting with verification.

7.13 QA review (PI, FC, QA RA)

1. Select **QA Queue**. Each submission shows the Sample ID, when it was submitted, the administration mode, the completion time in minutes and its QA status (PENDING or QUERY).

Figure 33. QUAN QA Queue with the KoboToolbox sync panel.

2. Open the completed form to check the answers: **Form PDFs → Download PDF**, or the **Completed questionnaire** panel on the case page.
3. Check it against the QA rules (table below) and any open QA exception for that case.
4. Write a **Note (required)** explaining your decision.
5. Select **Accept** (moves the case to S10 QA passed), **Re-query** (S09 QA query — follow up with the respondent or the RA who administered it) or **Reject** (not usable).

Rule	Setting	Effect
Required answers missing	65 required fields from the live questionnaire	Hard stop: raises an exception; cannot pass without a human decision and note.
Too quick	Completed in under 5 minutes (300 s)	Soft flag for review.
Too slow	Completed in over 90 minutes (5400 s)	Soft flag for review.
Possible duplicate	Another submission for the same organisation within 24 hours	Soft flag for review.

Nothing passes automatically

Even a submission with no flags needs a person to select Accept. Every decision and its note is audited.

Pulling new submissions now

Submissions arrive within seconds (KoboToolbox notifies the portal) and a full check runs every 15 minutes between 06:00 and 22:00 and hourly overnight. To check immediately, select **Sync now** in **KoboToolbox sync**; the panel shows the last run, how many were pulled and how many were new or updated. An edited submission returns to the queue for review.

7.14 QA exceptions (PI, FC, QA RA)

1. Select **QA Exceptions**. Each card shows the rule that fired (for example `hard_stop_missing_required_fields` or `min_plausible_duration_seconds`), the Sample ID, when it was raised and its status. Oldest first.

Figure 34. QA Exception Queue.

2. Tick **Only mine** to see exceptions assigned to you; tick **Show closed** to include resolved ones.
3. Use **Assign to** to take ownership (or give it to a colleague). The status becomes **In progress**.
4. Investigate: open the form PDF, check the case timeline, contact the respondent if needed.
5. Type **What was done about it?** and select **Resolved**, or **Not a real problem** if the flag was a false alarm. A note is always required.

7.15 Form PDFs and emailing (PI, FC, QA/KII/Doc RA)

1. Select **Form PDFs**. You see the completed form forms from KoboToolbox, newest first, 20 per page to begin with (choose more under **Show** at the foot of the list).

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
qa.ra · QUAN/Kobo QA RA

Change password Sign out

QA Dashboard Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions

← Back to QA Dashboard

Completed forms

✓ In sync with KoboToolbox
KoboToolbox holds 3 · the portal holds 3 · last synced 9/20/2026, 8:03:31 AM Sync now

SID-2026-000069 ✓ saved in portal Submitted 9/14/2026, 6:12:40 AM · web form	Download PDF	Email to me	Email to respondent
SID-2026-000071 ✓ saved in portal Submitted 9/13/2026, 12:40:02 PM · web form	Download PDF	Email to me	Email to respondent
SID-2026-000073 ✓ saved in portal Submitted 9/12/2026, 8:05:57 AM · web form	Download PDF	Email to me	Email to respondent

Showing 1 to 3 of 3 submissions Show: 20 per page Previous 1 Next

Figure 35. Completed form PDFs.

2. Select **Download PDF** to save a readable copy: sections, questions, the chosen answers as words (not codes) and repeated groups.
3. Select **Email to me** to send the PDF to the email address on your account.
4. For the questionnaire only, select **Email to respondent** to send the respondent a copy of their own answers at the email address recorded on the case (only while their consent stands). You are asked to confirm first. Every email is audited with the address masked.

At the top of the page, a sync panel shows whether the portal holds the same forms as KoboToolbox, for example “✓ In sync with KoboToolbox — KoboToolbox holds 12 · the portal holds 12”. Each row also says “✓ saved in portal” once the portal has an identical copy. If the panel says “Not in sync”, select **Sync now** (read-only roles see the panel but not the button); it takes a few seconds.

The same PDF is available from the record itself: the case page (questionnaire), the KII page (KII Guide) or the document page (coding form).

How the sync works

The portal keeps its own copy of the questionnaire, KII Guide and Document Analysis Tool, and refreshes it every 15 minutes and whenever someone selects Sync now. A submission edited in KoboToolbox is updated here; one deleted in KoboToolbox is flagged as removed. You never need to sync before downloading a PDF: the PDF is always read from KoboToolbox at that moment.

7.16 KII records (PI, FC, KII RA)

1. Select **KII Register → New KII record**.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
kura · KII RA

Change password Sign out

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs KII Register

← Back to KII Register

New KII Record

Stakeholder category

Participant name

Participant role

Preferred mode
PHONE

Create KII record

Figure 36. New KII Record.

- Enter **Stakeholder category**, **Participant name**, **Participant role** and **Preferred mode**, then select **Create KII record**. The KII ID (e.g. KII-0026) is generated.

7.16a Taking a KII from invitation to coded transcript

- In **KII Register**, select **Manage** on the record.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
kura · KII RA

Change password Sign out

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs KII Register

← Back to KII/Doc Dashboard

KII Register

Search KII ID, name or role

New KII record

KII ID	Stakeholder category	Status	Transcript	Coding	
KII-0001	Government / regulator	COMPLETED	VERIFIED	COMPLETE	Manage
KII-0002	Development finance institution	COMPLETED	IN_PROGRESS	IN_PROGRESS	Manage
KII-0003	Commercial bank	COMPLETED	ANONYMISED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0004	Agribusiness association	COMPLETED	VERIFIED	COMPLETE	Manage
KII-0005	Donor / NGO	COMPLETED	IN_PROGRESS	IN_PROGRESS	Manage
KII-0006	Academic expert	COMPLETED	ANONYMISED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0007	Government / regulator	COMPLETED	VERIFIED	COMPLETE	Manage
KII-0008	Development finance institution	COMPLETED	IN_PROGRESS	IN_PROGRESS	Manage
KII-0009	Commercial bank	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0010	Agribusiness association	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0011	Donor / NGO	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0012	Academic expert	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0013	Government / regulator	SCHEDULED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage
KII-0014	Development finance institution	INVITED	NOT_STARTED	NOT_STARTED	Manage

Figure 37. KII Register.

- Move the **Status** as things happen: PROSPECT → INVITED → SCHEDULED → COMPLETED, or DECLINED / NO_SHOW. Only valid next statuses are shown; NO_SHOW can be rescheduled.

The screenshot shows the 'KII record' interface for 'Simba Demo-Moyo' (KII-0009, Commercial bank, Policy Analyst). The interface is divided into several sections:

- Status: SCHEDULED**: Includes buttons for 'COMPLETED', 'NO_SHOW', and 'DECLINED'. A checkbox for 'Recording made (requires separate recording consent)' is present.
- Consent**: A section explaining that participation and recording consent are captured separately. It includes buttons for 'Record participation consent' (with status 'Participation: Not recorded') and 'Record recording consent' (with status 'Recording: Not recorded').
- Coding**: A section with the instruction 'Opens the KoboToolbox KII Guide with this record's KII-ID already filled in.' and a button 'Continue this interview'.
- Transcript: NOT_STARTED**: Includes buttons for 'NOT_STARTED', 'IN_PROGRESS', 'VERIFIED', and 'ANONYMISED'.
- Coding: NOT_STARTED**: Includes buttons for 'NOT_STARTED', 'IN_PROGRESS', and 'COMPLETE'.
- Completed KII form (KoboToolbox)**: A section stating 'No completed form in KoboToolbox for KII-0009 yet.'

Figure 38. KII record: status, consent, transcript and coding.

- Before the interview starts, select **Record participation consent**. If the interview will be recorded, also select **Record recording consent** — the two are always separate.
- When marking **COMPLETED**, tick **Recording made** only if a recording exists. The portal refuses a recorded completion without recording consent.
- Advance **Transcript** (NOT_STARTED → IN_PROGRESS → VERIFIED → ANONYMISED) and **Coding** (NOT_STARTED → IN_PROGRESS → COMPLETE) as the work progresses.
- Complete the **KII Guide** form in KoboToolbox using the KII ID (see the next section). The **Completed KII form (KoboToolbox)** panel then links to its PDF, and at the next sync (within 15 minutes, or at once with **Sync now** on **Form PDFs**) the portal sets **Coding** to COMPLETE for you.

7.16b Opening the KII Guide with the KII ID filled in

- Record **participation consent** first. Until you do, the **Coding** panel says “Record participation consent first” and the interview link is withheld.

The screenshot shows the 'Coding' panel with the message: 'Record participation consent first — the interview link is withheld until then.'

Figure 39. Before consent: no interview link.

- Once consent is recorded, the panel offers **Continue this interview**. Select it: the KoboToolbox KII Guide opens in a new tab with the KII ID already entered, so it can never be mistyped and the completed form always matches this record.

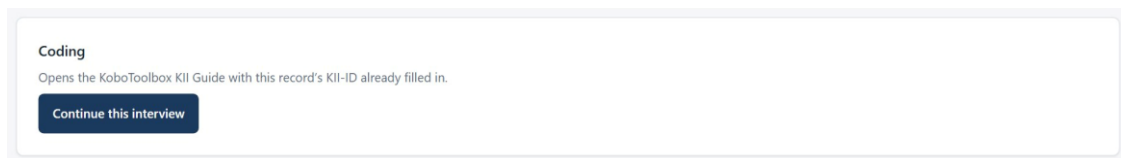


Figure 40. After consent: Continue this interview.

3. Complete the interview in the form as usual.

What the link carries

Only the KII ID and your own username. It never carries the participant's name, role or organisation, so nothing identifying is left in a web address or your browser history.

7.17 Document records (PI, FC, Documentary RA)

You do not need to type the details of a document. Upload it and the AI reads it, fills in the record, drafts the whole KoboToolbox coding form, and waits for you to review. (This needs AI drafting to be switched on; otherwise use “Adding a document by hand” below.)

1. Select **Documents** → **New document**. At the top is the box **Fastest: upload the document**.

Figure 41. New document: upload the file and let the AI do the rest.

2. Choose the file: a PDF, a Word (.docx) or Excel (.xlsx) file, a text or CSV file, or a JPG or PNG scan or photo (up to 20 MB). Nothing else is required.
3. Optional (open **Optional: title, pages to read**): a **Title** if you want your own; **Pages to read** if you are coding one chapter of a long PDF, for example 290–340; or tick **Read the whole document in parts** for a PDF over 100 pages (see “Coding a very long document” below).

4. Select **Upload and auto-fill**. The record is created straight away and the review screen opens, showing “Step 1 of 2: reading the document’s details”, then “Step 2 of 2: drafting the coding form”. You can leave the page; the draft will be there when you return.
5. The AI has filled in the title, author, date, document type, geographic scope, value chain and source it found in the document, and left blank anything the document does not state. Check them on the record page under **Record details** and correct anything wrong; a correction shows in the draft at once and is used when you submit.
6. You still make the human decisions: assess **authenticity** (Verified or Disputed) and **Include** or **Exclude** the document, as described below.
7. Review every section of the draft, **Save changes**, then **Submit to KoboToolbox** (see “Auto-fill: the AI drafts, you review”). The portal keeps its own copy of the completed form; **Sync now** on **Form PDFs** confirms the portal and KoboToolbox match.

7.17a Coding another chapter of the same document (Copy for another chapter)

A long report holds several evidence units. Give each chapter you want coded its own record, so each gets its own ratings, its own DOC ID and its own row in the export. You do not upload the file again or retype the details:

1. Open the record of the document and, under **Copy for another chapter**, enter the chapter's **Pages to read** (for example 290-340) and, if you like, a **Chapter title**. Leave the title empty and the AI names the part from its pages, for example “Title – Chapter 6: Agriculture (pp. 290-340)”.

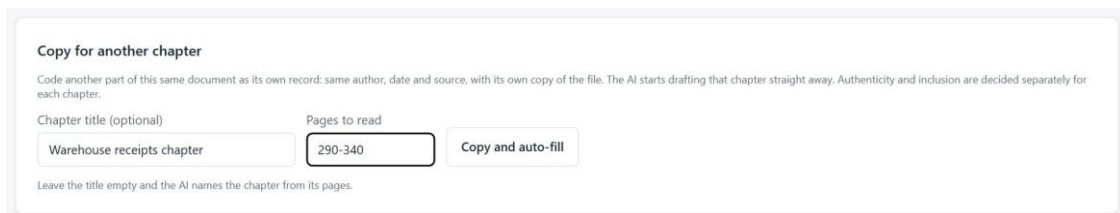


Figure 42. Copy for another chapter: pages, and an optional title.

2. Select **Copy and auto-fill** (or **Copy record** if AI drafting is not switched on). A new record is created with the same author, date, source, type and scope, and **its own copy of the file**, so removing or replacing one file never affects the other.
3. With AI drafting on, the new record's review screen opens and the AI starts drafting that chapter. Review, save and submit it as usual.
4. Authenticity and Include or Exclude are **not** copied: assess each chapter on its own. Repeat for every chapter you want coded.

Copy needs a file

The **Copy for another chapter** panel appears once a record has its source file. A title or pages is required, and a long PDF needs a page range (or the whole-document option). If the pages are not valid nothing is created.

7.17b Adding a document by hand

1. Select **Documents** → **New document** and, below **Or enter the details yourself**, fill in **Title, Author / speaker, Source URL / reference, Document type** (OFFICIAL, SECONDARY or PLATFORM), **Geographic**

scope and an **Evidence extract**, then select **Create document record**. The document ID (e.g. DOC-0025) is generated.

- Then attach the source file (below). If AI drafting is on, ticking **Start Auto-fill as soon as the file is uploaded** sends you straight to the draft.

7.17c Correcting a record's details

- Open the record. Under **Record details** you can edit the title, author, publication or event date, source URL or reference, geographic scope, value chain and document type.

Record details

These go into the coding form as they are. If Auto-fill filled them in from the document, check them here.

Title Example National Rural Finance Strategy 2026	Author / speaker Ministry of Example (fictional)
Publication or event date 03/12/2026	Source URL / reference https://example.org/rural-finance-strategy-2026
Geographic scope National	Value chain Cross-cutting
Document type OFFICIAL	

Save details

Figure 43. Record details: the details the AI filled in, ready to check.

- Select **Save details**. The details appear in the coding form's Section A: on the review screen they show in grey, and the corrected values are the ones submitted to KoboToolbox.

7.17d Attaching the source file, and removing a wrong one

- On the document's page, under **Source file**, select **Choose File** and pick the source: a PDF, a scan or photo (JPG or PNG), a Word (.docx) or Excel (.xlsx) file, or a text or CSV file. Audio and video can be attached as a reference. The limit is 20 MB. The file is stored privately on the server.

Source file

rural-finance-strategy-2026.pdf · 37 KB · uploaded 9/20/2026 [Remove file](#)

[Choose File](#) No file chosen

A scan, photo, screenshot or recording of the source (PDF, image, Office file or audio/video, up to 20 MB). Uploaded the wrong one? Remove it above, or choose another file to replace it.

☒ Start Auto-fill as soon as the file is uploaded

Figure 44. Source file: the file name, size and date, with Remove file beside it.

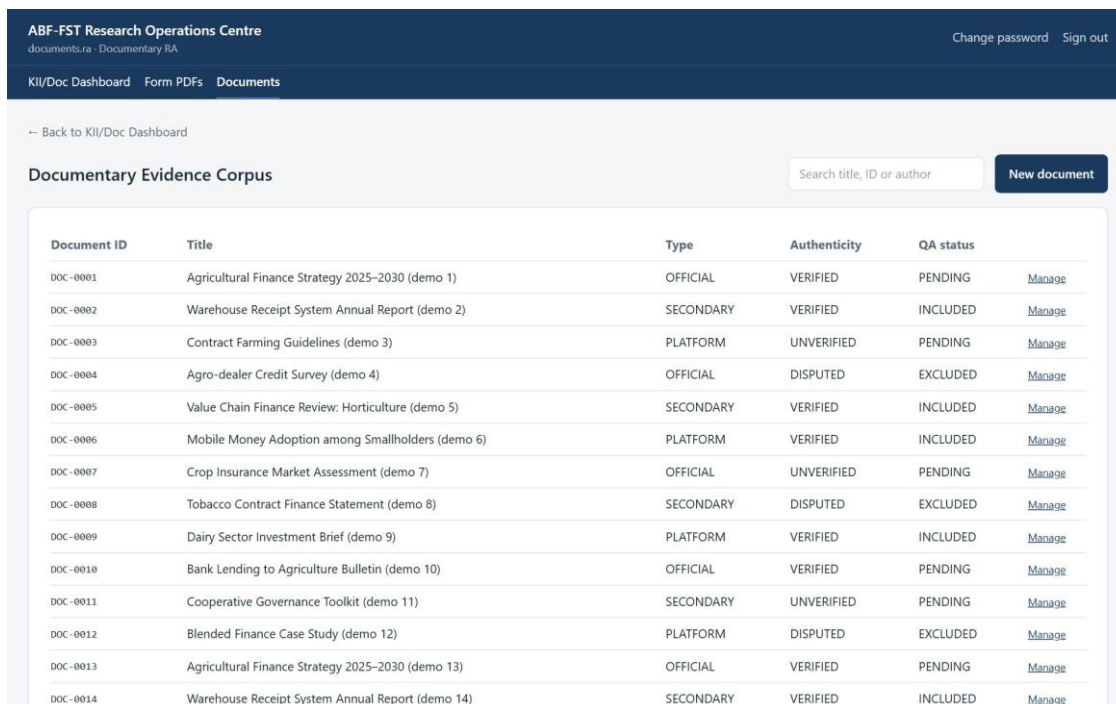
- A bar shows how much of the file has been sent. A large file on a slow connection can take a minute or two: wait until it says **Saving...** and the file name appears. If **Start Auto-fill as soon as the file is uploaded** is ticked (it is by default), the review screen then opens and the AI starts reading.
- Attached the wrong one? Select the red **Remove file** link beside the file name and confirm. The file is deleted from the server and the record says “No file uploaded yet”. Then choose the right file.
- Choosing another file straight away also replaces the old one.

What goes with a removed file

An AI draft (see below) made from the removed or replaced file is discarded too, so a draft of the wrong document can never be reviewed and submitted for the right one. A draft that has already been submitted to KoboToolbox is kept as the record of what was filed. Removals are recorded in the audit log with the file name.

7.17e Assessing and including a document

1. In **Documents**, select **Manage** on the record.



ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
documents.ra · Documentary RA

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

— Back to KII/Doc Dashboard

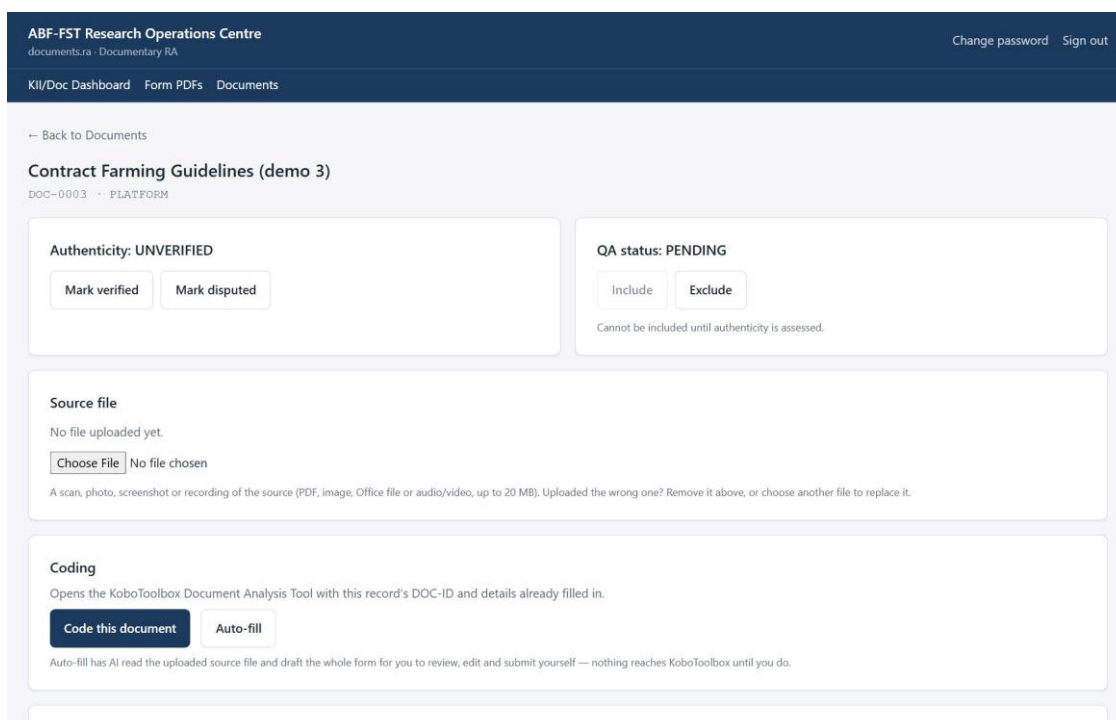
Documentary Evidence Corpus

Search title, ID or author New document

Document ID	Title	Type	Authenticity	QA status	
DOC-0001	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025–2030 (demo 1)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0002	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 2)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0003	Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)	PLATFORM	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0004	Agro-dealer Credit Survey (demo 4)	OFFICIAL	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0005	Value Chain Finance Review: Horticulture (demo 5)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0006	Mobile Money Adoption among Smallholders (demo 6)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0007	Crop Insurance Market Assessment (demo 7)	OFFICIAL	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0008	Tobacco Contract Finance Statement (demo 8)	SECONDARY	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0009	Dairy Sector Investment Brief (demo 9)	PLATFORM	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0010	Bank Lending to Agriculture Bulletin (demo 10)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0011	Cooperative Governance Toolkit (demo 11)	SECONDARY	UNVERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0012	Blended Finance Case Study (demo 12)	PLATFORM	DISPUTED	EXCLUDED	Manage
DOC-0013	Agricultural Finance Strategy 2025–2030 (demo 13)	OFFICIAL	VERIFIED	PENDING	Manage
DOC-0014	Warehouse Receipt System Annual Report (demo 14)	SECONDARY	VERIFIED	INCLUDED	Manage

Figure 45. Documentary Evidence Corpus.

2. Assess authenticity: select **Mark verified** or **Mark disputed**.



ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
documents.ra · Documentary RA

KII/Doc Dashboard Form PDFs Documents

— Back to Documents

Contract Farming Guidelines (demo 3)
DOC-0003 · PLATFORM

Authenticity: UNVERIFIED

[Mark verified](#) [Mark disputed](#)

QA status: PENDING

[Include](#) [Exclude](#)

Cannot be included until authenticity is assessed.

Source file

No file uploaded yet.

[Choose File](#) No file chosen

A scan, photo, screenshot or recording of the source (PDF, image, Office file or audio/video, up to 20 MB). Uploaded the wrong one? Remove it above, or choose another file to replace it.

Coding

Opens the KoboToolbox Document Analysis Tool with this record's DOC-ID and details already filled in.

[Code this document](#) [Auto-fill](#)

Auto-fill has AI read the uploaded source file and draft the whole form for you to review, edit and submit yourself — nothing reaches KoboToolbox until you do.

Figure 46. Document record: authenticity, QA status, memo and coding form.

3. Set the QA status: **Include** or **Exclude**. A document cannot be included until authenticity has been assessed.
4. Write the **Interpretive memo** (dispute reasons, interpretation notes) and select **Save memo**.
5. Code the document (next two sections). The completed form's PDF then appears on the record, under **Completed coding form (KoboToolbox)**.

7.17f Coding a document: two ways

The **Coding** panel offers two buttons for the Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool:

Button	What it does	Use it when
Code this document	Opens the KoboToolbox Document Analysis Tool with the DOC ID, title, author, date and source already filled in. You answer every other question yourself.	You code by hand, or the source cannot be read by the AI.
Auto-fill	Has the AI read the uploaded source file and draft answers to the whole form. You review, edit and submit.	A source file is uploaded and you want a fast first draft. The button only appears once the administrator has switched AI drafting on.

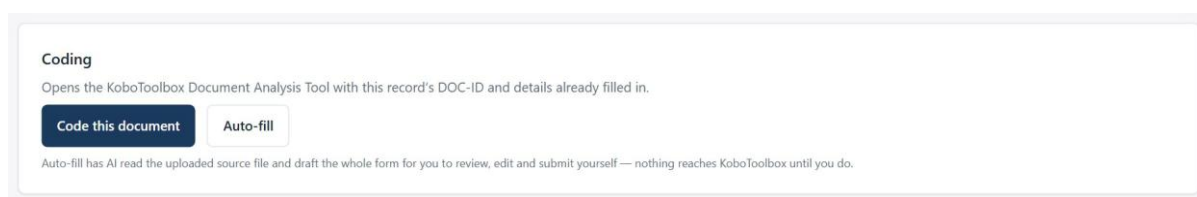


Figure 47. The Coding panel: Code this document, and Auto-fill.

7.17g Auto-fill: the AI drafts, you review

1. Attach the source file (above). Select **Auto-fill** in the **Coding** panel; the review screen opens.
2. If the file is a PDF of more than 100 pages, enter the **Pages to read**, for example 10-90. The AI reads up to 100 pages at a time, so either choose the pages that make up this evidence unit, such as one chapter, or tick **Read the whole document in parts** (see "Coding a very long document" below). Its locators use the original page numbers. For shorter files, leave the box empty to read everything.

Figure 48. A 240-page PDF: enter a page range, or read the whole document in parts.

3. Select **Generate AI draft**. The AI reads in the background, usually one to five minutes. You can leave the page and come back; the draft will be there.

Figure 49. The AI is reading the document.

4. Read the draft. It has every section of the KoboToolbox form, A to L. The DOC ID, author, title, date and source come from the record and cannot be changed here; everything else you can edit.

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre

documents.ra · Documentary RA

Change password

Sign out

KII/Doc Dashboard

Form PDFs

Documents

← Back to Document

Auto-fill: Example National Rural Finance Strategy 2026

DOC-0025

Pages to read (optional)

all pages

Regenerate draft

Save changes

Submit to KoboToolbox

Drafted 9/20/2026, 4:52:13 AM by claude-opus-5. Read every field before saving or submitting -- this is a starting point, not a finished coding.

A. Source Identification and Provenance

The grey fields come from the record (the AI read them from the document's first pages when the record was made). To correct one, [edit the record details](#); the change appears here and is used when you submit.

DOC-ID

DOC-0025

Organisation / author

Ministry of Example (fictional)

Title / evidence unit

Example National Rural Finance Strategy 2026

Source class

Financing product/guideline

If Other, please specify

Fictional demonstration text for: If Other, please specify. See page 12, paragraph 4.

Publication/event date

2026-03-12

Access/capture date

2026-09-20

Figure 50. The review screen: the draft, ready to check and edit.

5. Check the judgements, not just the facts: the strength ratings (Sections D and H), the hypothesis codes (Section K) and the locators. Open the source and confirm a few page or paragraph references.

D. Agribusiness Bankability Index — ABI Core Dimensions

D1 Governance & Risk Management — Strength

Moderate

D1 Governance & Risk Management — Evidence summary

Fictional demonstration text for: D1 Governance & Risk Management — Evidence summary. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D1 Governance & Risk Management — Locator

Fictional demonstration text for: D1 Governance & Risk Management — Locator. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D2 Contractual Credibility — Strength

Moderate

D2 Contractual Credibility — Evidence summary

Fictional demonstration text for: D2 Contractual Credibility — Evidence summary. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D2 Contractual Credibility — Locator

Fictional demonstration text for: D2 Contractual Credibility — Locator. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Strength

Weak

D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Evidence summary

Fictional demonstration text for: D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Evidence summary. See page 12, paragraph 4.

D3 Cash-Flow Predictability — Locator

Figure 51. Section D: ratings and locators, all editable.

- Check the numbers in Section J against the source. Add or remove metrics as needed.

J. Quantitative Evidence Extraction Add metric

Metric: Other

If Other, please specify: Share of farmers with a bank account

Value: 62%

Unit/currency: percent

Period: 2025

Population/geography: National

Target/forecast/actual: Actual

Locator: Table 3, page 21

Remove this metric

Metric: Other

If Other, please specify: Target for warehouse receipt volume

Value: 150,000

Unit/currency: tonnes

Period: 2030

Population/geography: National

Target/forecast/actual: Target

Locator: Paragraph 9.3, page 44

Remove this metric

Figure 52. Section J: quantitative metrics.

- Select **Save changes** to keep your edits and finish later. When you are satisfied, select **Submit to KoboToolbox** and confirm. Your reviewed answers are sent as a completed record.

8. The record appears at once under **Completed coding form (KoboToolbox)** on the document page and in **Form PDFs**, found by its DOC ID. The portal's copy of the Document Analysis Tool is refreshed the moment you submit. If a coding you submitted is later deleted in KoboToolbox, the next sync (automatic, or **Sync now** on **Form PDFs**) unlocks the document so it can be coded again.

The draft is a starting point, not a finding

Sections D to K are this study's documentary analysis. The AI drafts them; you are responsible for them. Change any rating you disagree with. A draft where everything is rated as strongly supportive deserves a second look.

Nothing reaches KoboToolbox until you select **Submit**. Each draft and submission is recorded in the audit log, so the study can say exactly which records were AI-assisted.

Submit once. A second submission would create a duplicate record for the document, and the screen shows "Already submitted" to stop it.

File type	Can the AI read it?	Locators
PDF	Yes, up to 100 pages at a time; longer files by page range, or read whole in parts (up to 1,500 pages).	Original page and paragraph numbers.
JPG, PNG (scan or photo)	Yes. Very large photos are shrunk automatically.	Whatever the image shows.
Word (.docx), Excel (.xlsx), text, CSV	Yes, as text.	No page numbers: headings, paragraph or section numbers, sheet names.
Audio or video	No. Upload a transcript (PDF, Word or text) and keep the recording as the source reference.	-
Old .doc or .xls	No. Save as a PDF or as .docx / .xlsx and upload that.	-

Coding a very long document

The AI can take in 100 pages at a time. A report of several hundred or a thousand pages therefore needs one of two approaches:

- **One record per chapter (recommended).** Make a record for each part you want coded, for example "NDS2 – Agriculture chapter": upload the PDF once, then use **Copy for another chapter** on that record for every further part, entering each part's page range (see "Coding another chapter of the same document" above). Review and submit each one. Each part gets its own DOC ID, its own coding and its own row in the Excel export.
- **Read the whole document in parts.** Tick **Read the whole document in parts**. Leave **Pages to read** empty for every page, or enter a longer range such as 1-600 (up to 1,500 pages). The AI codes each part of about 80 pages, then combines them into one draft for the record. The screen tells you how many parts it will take and asks you to confirm, then shows progress ("Read part 3 of 8", then "Combining the parts into one draft"). Expect roughly ten to thirty minutes, and you can leave the page.

A combined draft needs extra care

Because the ratings are judged across the parts rather than from every page at once, check the strength ratings (Sections D and H), the hypothesis codes (Section K) and the locators more carefully than for a single chapter. The draft states which pages it covers; confirm that this is the evidence unit you meant.

A whole-document read costs about the number of parts plus one times an ordinary draft. If any part fails, the whole draft fails and nothing is saved, so you never receive a coding that silently skipped pages.

Whether a whole-document coding is appropriate for a given source is a methodology decision for the PI; for a report that covers many topics, one record per chapter usually gives a sharper analysis.

If Auto-fill shows a message

You see	What it means	What to do
"Pages to read (required)", or "This PDF has N pages..."	The PDF is longer than 100 pages.	Enter a page range of up to 100 pages, or tick Read the whole document in parts.
"...over the 1500-page ceiling..."	The PDF is longer than the most that can be read in one draft.	Enter a page range, or make one record per chapter.
"Step 1 of 2..." or "Step 2 of 2..."	A record made by Quick add is being filled in and drafted. Nothing is wrong.	Wait, or leave the page and come back.
A detail in Section A is wrong or blank	The AI reads only what the document states, and can mistake a title or date.	Correct it under Record details on the record page; the draft and the submission use the corrected value.
Quick add says the file can't be used	Unsupported type (for example audio), a damaged file, or a long PDF with no pages chosen.	Read the message: convert the file, enter a page range, or tick Read the whole document in parts. No record is created when this happens.
"Reconcile the pre-interview profile first..." when accepting a questionnaire, or a KII's coding will not complete	The case has a locked pre-interview profile with facts not yet verified with the respondent or not reconciled.	Open the case (or KII record) → Interview sheet; verify every fact, and ask the coordinator to reconcile the corrected ones.
"Read part 4 of 12" or "Combining the parts..."	A long document is being read in parts. Nothing is wrong.	Wait, or leave the page and come back.
"The AI's answer was cut off..."	The range was too big to answer in one go.	Try a narrower range.
"A draft is already being generated"	You or a colleague already started one.	Wait for it to finish (about five minutes; up to half an hour for a document read in parts).
"The last attempt failed: ..."	The AI request did not complete.	Select Generate AI draft again. If it keeps failing, tell the administrator the message.
"The AI account has run out of credit..."	The study's AI account has no funds left.	Tell the administrator to add credit in the Anthropic console; nothing else to do on this screen.
No Auto-fill button	AI drafting has not been switched on, or there is no source file yet.	Attach the file; otherwise ask the administrator.
Submit is refused by KoboToolbox	KoboToolbox did not accept the record.	Tell the administrator; your draft is kept.

Cost

Each draft is a paid request on the study's AI account. A short chapter costs little; a full 100 pages costs several times more; a whole document read in parts costs about the number of parts plus one times an ordinary draft. Choose the pages you need.

7.18 Logging costs (PI, FC)

- 1. Select **Cost**. The top shows total spend, cost per QA-passed questionnaire and cost per completed KII, with spend by category.

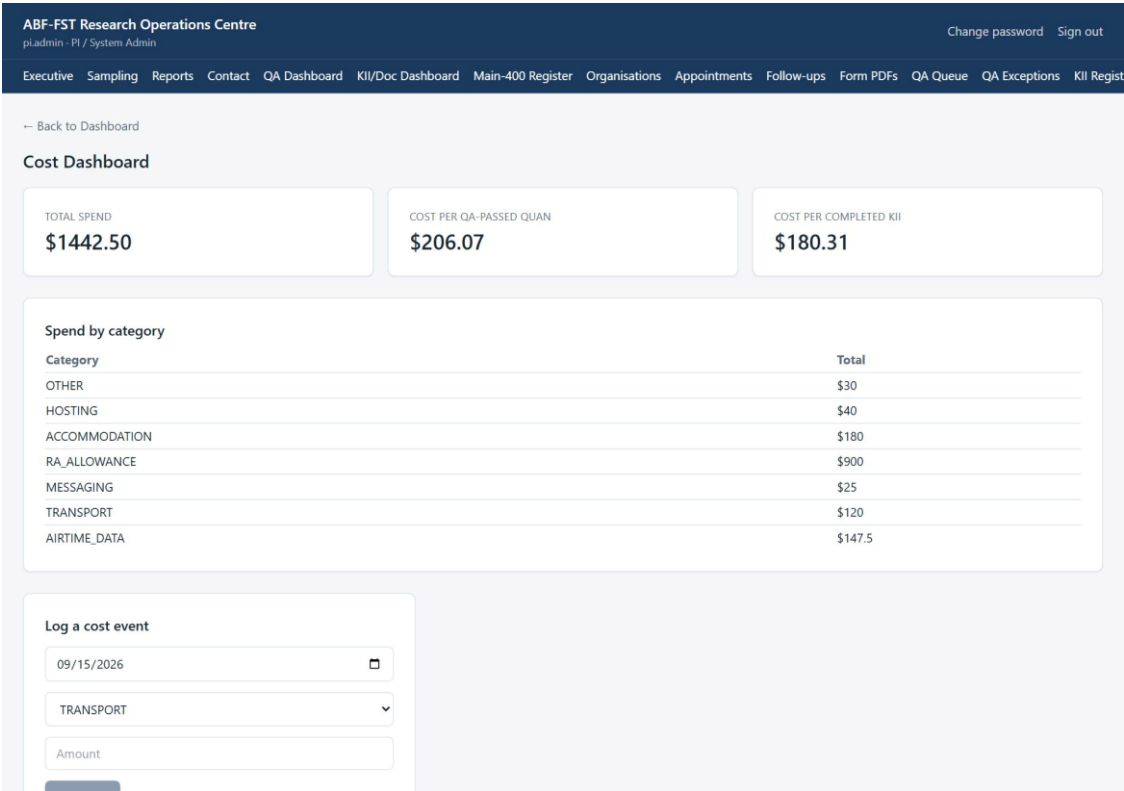


Figure 53. Cost Dashboard and the Log a cost event form.

- 2. In **Log a cost event**, enter the date, choose the category (RA_ALLOWANCE, AIRTIME_DATA, TRANSPORT, ACCOMMODATION, HOSTING, MESSAGING, OTHER) and the amount in USD.
- 3. Select **Log cost**. Keep the receipt as the study's finance rules require.

7.19 Downloading data (PI, FC, Analyst)

ABF-FST Research Operations Centre
pi.admin · PI / System Admin

Change password Sign out

Executive Sampling Reports Contact QA Dashboard KII/Doc Dashboard Main-400 Register Organisations Appointments Follow-ups Form PDFs QA Queue QA Exceptions KII Register

← Back to Dashboard

Data Export

De-identified analysis export

CSV with no contact-identifying fields -- safe for analysis and sharing with the wider research team. Available to Analysts, Field Coordinators and the PI/Admin.

Download analysis export (CSV)

Full operational export

Includes contact data (names, phone, email, gatekeeper details). Internal operations use only -- never distributed externally. PI/Admin only.

Download operational export (CSV)

KoboToolbox data — every completed form

Straight from KoboToolbox. The Excel workbook has one row per submission with answers as codes (for SPSS, Stata or R) and as labels, a question dictionary, the choice lists, and a sheet for each repeating group; questionnaire rows also show the matched case, QA state and any withdrawal. The ZIP holds every completed form as a PDF with a manifest. PI only; every download is audited.

Main Study Questionnaire	Excel workbook	All completed forms (PDF ZIP)
Main Study KII Guide	Excel workbook	All completed forms (PDF ZIP)
Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool	Excel workbook	All completed forms (PDF ZIP)

A large ZIP starts downloading straight away and grows as each form is added.

Research study: This portal supports data collection for a doctoral research study on agribusiness financing readiness. Your participation and responses are used for research purposes only. No score, rating, or

Figure 54. Data Export.

Download	Contains	Who
De-identified analysis export (CSV)	One row per questionnaire: sample_id, master_id, province, actor_family, value_chain, size_class, administration_mode, qa_status, submitted_at, completion_seconds. No names or contact details. Participants who withdrew are left out.	PI, Field Coordinator, Analyst
Full operational export (CSV)	Every questionnaire, including withdrawn ones (consent_withdrawn), plus organisation name, respondent name, phone, email and gatekeeper details. Internal operations only.	PI only
KoboToolbox data: Excel workbook	Every submission's answers for one form: data_codes (codes for SPSS/Stata/R), data_labels, a sheet per repeat group, the questions dictionary, the choices lists, and for the questionnaire the matched case, QA status, withdrawal flag and workflow status.	PI only
KoboToolbox data: All completed forms (PDF ZIP)	Every completed form as a PDF, with manifest.csv listing file, record, KoboToolbox id and submission time.	PI only

Getting all the data for cleaning and analysis

1. Select **Export**.
2. Under **KoboToolbox data — every completed form**, select **Excel workbook** for the **Main Study Questionnaire**. Repeat for the **Main Study KII Guide** and the **Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool**.
3. Select **All completed forms (PDF ZIP)** for each form you need as PDFs. A large ZIP starts at once and grows while it downloads — let it finish.

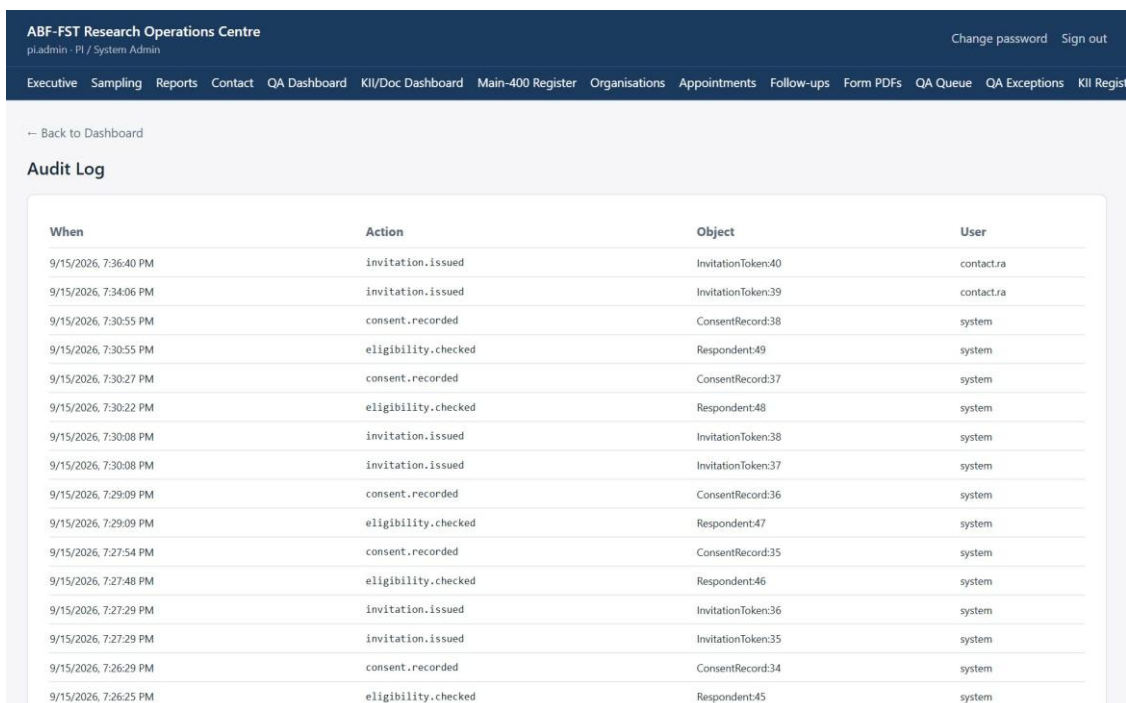
4. Open the workbook's **README** sheet first. Use `data_codes` for statistical software and `data_labels` for reading. `meta/rootUuid` identifies a submission across edits; `_parent_id` links repeat rows to their submission.
5. For analysis without identities, share only the **De-identified analysis export** and the workbook columns you have checked contain no names or contact details.

Handle raw data carefully

Workbooks and PDFs contain the answers themselves, and the KII Guide identifies people. Store them only on encrypted, access-controlled storage as the data management plan requires. Every download is recorded in the audit log.

7.20 Audit log (PI)

1. Select **Audit Log**. Each row shows when, the action (e.g. `invitation.issued`, `consent.recorded`, `sampling.bulk_workflow_transition`, `kobo.data_exported`), the record, and the user.



When	Action	Object	User
9/15/2026, 7:36:40 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:40	contact.ra
9/15/2026, 7:34:06 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:39	contact.ra
9/15/2026, 7:30:55 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:38	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:55 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:49	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:27 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:37	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:22 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:48	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:08 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:38	system
9/15/2026, 7:30:08 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:37	system
9/15/2026, 7:29:09 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:36	system
9/15/2026, 7:29:09 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:47	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:54 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:35	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:48 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:46	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:29 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:36	system
9/15/2026, 7:27:29 PM	invitation.issued	InvitationToken:35	system
9/15/2026, 7:26:29 PM	consent.recorded	ConsentRecord:34	system
9/15/2026, 7:26:25 PM	eligibility.checked	Respondent:45	system

Figure 55. Audit Log, newest first.

2. Page through with **Previous** and **Next**. Actions taken by scheduled jobs or by respondents themselves show **system**.

7.21 Manual status changes (PI, FC, Contact RA)

Most statuses move automatically. Use **Advance workflow status** on the case page only for decisions a person makes, such as recording that an organisation is ineligible or has refused.

1. On the case page, find **Advance workflow status**. Only the transitions allowed from the current status are shown, e.g. **→ S04** or **→ S14**.

Advance workflow status

→ S06 → S12 → S13

Figure 56. Only valid next statuses are offered.

2. Log a contact attempt or note explaining the decision first.
3. Select the new status. The change is audited.

From	Can move to
S00	S01
S01	S02, S15
S02	S03, S14, S15
S03	S04, S14
S04	S05
S05, S06, S07	Next step, S12 Refused, S13 Nonresponse
S08	S09, S10
S09	S10
S10	S11
S12–S15	S16 Reserve eligible for activation

7.22 Recording a withdrawal (PI, FC)

A participant may withdraw at any time, for any reason, without giving one.

1. Stop contacting the person immediately.
2. On the case page, in **Record a withdrawal**, choose **How they told us — By phone or in person**, or **In writing (WhatsApp, email, letter)** — and type the reason or their own words.

Record a withdrawal

Use when the participant asks to withdraw. Their link stops working, reminders stop, and their phone, WhatsApp, email and gatekeeper contact are erased. This can't be undone.

How they told us

By phone or in person ▼

Reason or their words

Record withdrawal

Figure 57. Record a withdrawal.

3. Select **Record withdrawal** and confirm.

In one step the portal records the withdrawal, stops the invitation link and all reminders, moves the case to **S12 Refused** where allowed, erases the phone, WhatsApp, email and gatekeeper contact, and flags the case as `consent_withdrawn` in every export. This cannot be undone.

Answers already submitted

PI decision (15 September 2026): a questionnaire submitted before the withdrawal is **kept for the audit trail but never analysed**. It is left out of the de-identified analysis export automatically, flagged `consent_withdrawn` in the operational export, and marked in the PI's KoboToolbox workbook (README count and `portal_consent_withdrawn = TRUE`) and PDF ZIP (file name starts WITHDRAWN-).

7.23 When the person is not eligible

- If someone chooses **None of these describe me**, the portal thanks them and the questionnaire never opens. No answers are recorded.
- Ask them politely to nominate the right senior person, record that person under **Respondents and contact details**, and send a new invitation.
- If nobody suitable exists, record the reason in the contact timeline and move the case to **S14 Ineligible** (Field Coordinator or PI).

7.24 PROIT pre-interview profile with AI research (PI, FC)

PROIT lets the respondent confirm facts already on public record instead of answering them from scratch, and lets the interviewer ask only what is **not** public. It never pre-fills, skips or infers any scale item (ABI, NFM, Digital Readiness, FST): only descriptive background. This applies to the questionnaire and to the KIIs alike.

Step 1: let the AI search public sources

1. On the case page (or KII page), in **Pre-Interview Profile (PROIT)**, select **Start background research**.
2. In the **AI research from public sources** box, select **Research with AI**. The AI searches the public web for the organisation, and for the respondent's published professional role, and works in the background for a few minutes. You can leave the page and come back.

AI research from public sources

The AI searches the public web for this organisation and the respondent's published professional role, and proposes background facts with a source and a quote for each. Nothing enters the profile until you accept it. The organisation name, and the respondent's name and role, are sent to the AI provider's search. It never records anything private.

[Research again](#)

Searched the company registry entry, the website and two trade-press articles for Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative in Harare. The registry and website agree on the name and address. Financing and insurance are not documented publicly. (9 searches.)

To review (5)

Registered/legal organisation name HIGH

Proposed value (edit before accepting if needed)

Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative (Private) Limited, registered in Zimbabwe.

Company registry extract: Registrar of Companies (example) - 2025-06-10 - Tier 1
"Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative (Private) Limited"

[Accept](#) [Reject](#)

Year established HIGH

Proposed value (edit before accepting if needed)

Incorporated in 2011.

Company registry extract: Registrar of Companies (example) - 2025-06-10 - Tier 1
"Date of incorporation: 14 March 2011"
About us: Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative - 2024 - Tier 2
"Serving Zimbabwean farmers since 2011"

[Accept](#) [Reject](#)

Key products/services MODERATE

Proposed value (edit before accepting if needed)

Seed, fertiliser and crop-protection inputs for smallholder and commercial growers.

Products: Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative - 2024 - Tier 2
"Seed, fertiliser and agrochemicals for every season"

[Accept](#) [Reject](#)

HQ district MODERATE

Proposed value (edit before accepting if needed)

Harare.

Contact us: Musasa Valley Growers Cooperative - 2024 - Tier 2
"Head office, Harare"
A second branch is listed in Bulawayo; the head office is Harare.

[Accept](#) [Reject](#)

Participation in public/development programmes LOW

Proposed value (edit before accepting if needed)

Listed as an input supplier under a public input-support programme.

Programme supplier list: Ministry of Lands (example) - 2022 - Tier 3
"Registered input suppliers, Harare"
The list is from 2022; check that it is still current.

[Accept](#) [Reject](#)

Figure 58. AI research: proposals to review, each with its sources.

- Under **To review**, read each proposal. It gives the fact, a confidence level, and every source it used with the publisher, the date, the authority tier and a short quote copied from the page. Select the source title to open the page and check it yourself.
- Decide on each one. **Accept** puts it into the profile with its sources. Edit the wording first if it needs correcting, then **Accept**. **Reject** discards it. Nothing enters the profile until you accept it. Take special care where the note says the organisation may be a different one with a similar name.
- Read **Not found publicly: ask the respondent**. These are the facts the AI could not find in any public source. They become the questions the interviewer asks in full.

Cost

PROIT research is a paid request on the study's AI account, run on a lower-cost model than document drafting (about USD 1-3 per organisation researched). Research the organisations that need it rather than re-running it on the same one.

The AI proposes, you decide

The AI only suggests. Every fact still needs a source, a person to accept it and a second person to lock the profile, exactly as if you had typed it in.

Only sources the search actually returned can be cited. A fact with no verifiable source is turned into “not found publicly”, and anything that looks private is removed automatically. The AI never records health, religion, ethnicity, politics, family, home addresses, personal phone numbers or emails, private finances, or anything from personal social-media pages.

What is sent to the AI provider's search: the organisation's name, province, district and type, and the respondent's name and role. Never a phone number, email, gatekeeper or any other contact detail.

Step 2: add or correct facts by hand

- Under **Add a background field**, choose a field in **Select a field...**, type **What was found (documentary value)**, and select **Add field**.

Figure 59. A draft profile: each fact needs at least one source.

- For each field, type the **Source title** (e.g. companies registry entry), choose the confidence (HIGH, MODERATE, LOW) and the authority tier — Tier 1 statutory register or audited report, Tier 2 official website or association record, Tier 3 reputable media or professional profile, Tier 4 corroborated public platform content — then select **Add source**.
- Use **Researcher review screen** to check the whole profile, including gaps and contradictions.
- A second researcher reviews it and selects **Lock pre-profile**. Only a locked profile is used with the respondent, who confirms, corrects, or says they don't know, prefer not to say, or it is not applicable. The public value, the respondent's answer and the reconciled value are kept separately.

7.25 Reassigning cases in bulk (PI, FC)

Use **Reassign cases** on the Main-400 Register to hand many cases to a Contact RA at once — for example when new RAs start, or when an RA leaves. For a single case, use **Assigned Contact RA** on the case page.

- Open **Main-400 Register** and find **Reassign cases** (below the verification tool).
- Choose **From** (Anyone, Unassigned, or a Contact RA), a **Province** or All provinces, and **To** (the Contact RA receiving the cases, or Nobody to unassign).

Figure 60. Reassign cases: the button shows how many cases will move.

- To split a large province, type a number in **How many**. Cases move in Sample ID order, so move part of the province to one RA, then the rest to the next.
- Select **Move N cases** and confirm. The move is written to the audit log with every Sample ID.

What the RA sees

A Contact RA sees only the cases assigned to them, including on Follow-ups. Reassigning a case moves its reminders with it.

7.26 Verifying a profile with the respondent and reconciling it (FC, PI, KII RA, Contact RA)

Once a profile is locked, the interview has two duties: confirm what is public, and ask what is not. The **Interview sheet** is where you do both, and where the results are reconciled afterwards. It appears on the locked profile on the case page (coordinator and PI), on the case page of an assisted interview (Contact RA) and on the KII record (KII RA). Nothing here changes the public value.

- Open the case (or the KII record) and find **Interview sheet: confirm what is public, ask what is not**. Each row is one fact and is marked **Confirm**, **Confirm**, then **probe** or **Ask**.

Interview sheet: confirm what is public, ask what is not Verified 4 of 5 - settled 3 of 5

Read each public fact to the respondent and record what they say. Never state a fact shown as "Ask". It is a question, not something established. Their answer is kept separately and never replaces the public value.

Registered/legal organisation name Confirm Settled

Public source says: Ironwood Vale Dairy Processors (Private) Limited
[Company registry extract - example.org](#)

What the respondent said
 Confirmed: it is correct Comment (optional) Save answer

Recorded: Confirmed: it is correct

Year established Confirm Settled

Public source says: 2011
[Company registry extract - example.org](#)

What the respondent said
 Confirmed: it is correct Comment (optional) Save answer

Recorded: Confirmed: it is correct

HQ district Confirm Differs from the public source

Public source says: Harare
[Contact us page - example.org](#)

What the respondent said
 Partly correct or out of date Head office in Harare; main depot in Marondera Moved the depot last year Save answer

Recorded: Partly correct or out of date — "Head office in Harare; main depot in Marondera"

Reconciled value (required)
 The value you code for analysis Save reconciled value

Key products/services Confirm

Public source says: Seed, fertiliser and crop-protection inputs
[Products page - example.org](#)

What the respondent said
 Choose... Comment (optional) Save answer

Publicly disclosed lenders/finance facilities Ask Settled

Not found publicly. Ask this in full.

What the respondent said
 They told us A working-capital line with a commercial bank, renewed each se Comment (optional) Save answer

Recorded: They told us — "A working-capital line with a commercial bank, renewed each season"

Reconciled value
 Working-capital facility with a commercial bank (respondent-reported) Save reconciled value

Interview finished 9/21/2026, 9:41:36 PM Record a protocol deviation

The case cannot be passed by QA (questionnaire) or have its coding completed (KII) until every fact here is verified with the respondent and, where they corrected or qualified it, reconciled.

Figure 61. The interview sheet: confirm what is public, ask what is not.

- For a **Confirm** row, read the public fact to the respondent, with its source shown under it, and ask whether it is right. Never state a fact on an **Ask** row: it is a question, not something established. A weak source's value is deliberately hidden.
- In **What the respondent said**, choose the answer: confirmed, corrected, partly correct or out of date, does not know, prefers not to say, or does not apply. For a correction, type **Their answer**. Add a comment if useful, then select **Save answer**.
- For an **Ask** row, choose **They told us** and type what they said, or record that they do not know or would rather not say.
- When the interview is over, select **Interview finished**.

After the interview: reconcile (coordinator and PI)

- Rows where the respondent corrected or qualified a fact show **Differs from the public source**. Under **Reconciled value (required)**, type the value you code for analysis, then select **Save reconciled value**. A plain confirmation or “does not apply” needs no reconciled value.

The screenshot shows a web form for reconciling a fact. At the top, it says 'HQ district' and 'Public source says: Harare'. There are two buttons: 'Confirm' and 'Differs from the public source' (which is highlighted in red). Below this, there is a link 'Contact us page · example.org' and a section 'What the respondent said'. This section has a dropdown menu with 'Partly correct or out of date' selected, and two text input fields: 'Head office in Harare; main depot in Marondera' and 'Moved the depot last year'. To the right of these fields is a 'Save answer' button. Below this, it says 'Recorded: Partly correct or out of date — "Head office in Harare; main depot in Marondera"'. At the bottom, there is a section 'Reconciled value (required)' with a text input field 'The value you code for analysis' and a 'Save reconciled value' button.

Figure 62. Reconciling a corrected fact: the three values stay separate.

- The status at the top of the sheet counts up: “Verified 6 of 8 · settled 5 of 8”, then **Reconciled** when every fact is settled. At that moment the portal also sends the whole profile (what was known, what the respondent said, the reconciled value, and the sources) to KoboToolbox, in the **ABF-FST PROIT Interview Profile** form, and the status shows **Saved to KoboToolbox**.
- If reconciliation truly cannot be finished (for example the respondent cannot be reached again), select **Record a protocol deviation** and give the reason. The case is released but stays flagged.

A case is not complete until its profile is reconciled

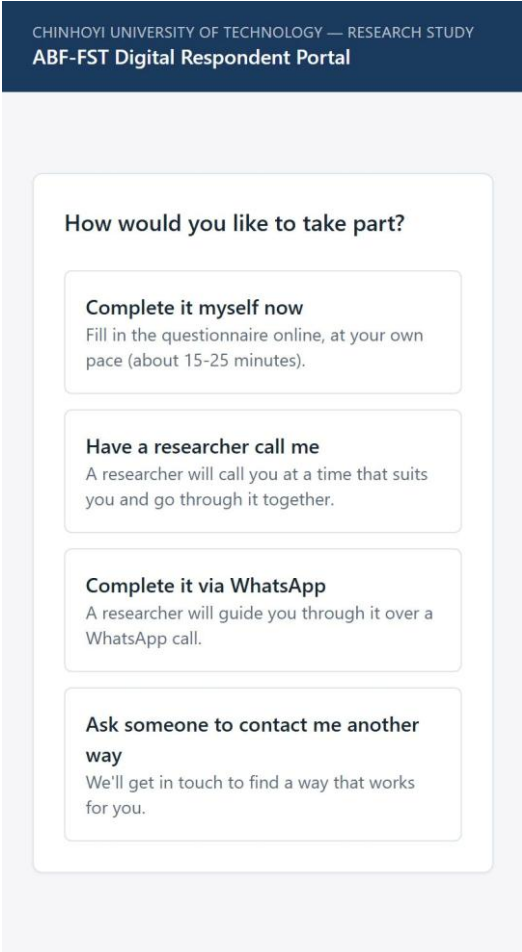
QA cannot **Accept** a questionnaire, and a KII's coding cannot become COMPLETE, while a locked profile still has facts not verified with the respondent or not reconciled. The message says how many are outstanding. Re-query and Reject are never blocked.

This applies only to a case that has a locked profile with facts on it. A case with no profile is not held up.

8. The respondent's experience

What respondents see on their phone. The separate **Respondent Guide** can be shared with respondents as it is.

Screen	What the respondent does
Confirm organisation	Confirms "is this <organisation>?" with Yes, that's correct, or contacts the team if not.
A little about you	Enters their name and role; None of these describe me ends politely without any questions.
Participant Information	Reads the information sheet (v1.3), then Continue to consent or Go back.
Your consent	I agree to take part or I do not wish to take part; can re-read the information.
Before we continue (PROIT)	Only if a locked profile exists: confirms, corrects or skips background facts.
How would you like to take part?	Complete it myself now, Have a researcher call me, Complete it via WhatsApp, or Ask someone to contact me another way.
Questionnaire	Start the questionnaire opens the KoboToolbox form (about 15–25 minutes).
When works best for you?	For a call: picks a future date and time and selects Request this time.
Thank you	Neutral closing message. No score or rating.



CHINHOYI UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY — RESEARCH STUDY
ABF-FST Digital Respondent Portal

How would you like to take part?

Complete it myself now
Fill in the questionnaire online, at your own pace (about 15-25 minutes).

Have a researcher call me
A researcher will call you at a time that suits you and go through it together.

Complete it via WhatsApp
A researcher will guide you through it over a WhatsApp call.

Ask someone to contact me another way
We'll get in touch to find a way that works for you.

Figure 63. Choosing how to take part (phone view).

8.1 Message templates

The invitation screen writes the approved invitation message for WhatsApp automatically. The approved reminders are:

Day 2 reminder	Hello, this is a reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation sent to your organisation. Please use the link you were sent to take part, or reply here if you have questions.
Day 7 final routine attempt	Hello, this is a final reminder about the ABF-FST research study invitation. If you would still like to take part, please use the link you were sent. Thank you.

9. KoboToolbox administration (PI)

9.1 The connected forms

Form	Public web link	Portal setting
Main Study Questionnaire	https://ee.kobotoolbox.org/x/fSOJedrV	KOBO_ASSET_UID, KOBO_FORM_URL
Main Study KII Guide	https://ee.kobotoolbox.org/x/hwMQ5dG3	KOBO_KII_ASSET_UID
Document, Digital Platform & Media Analysis Tool	https://ee.kobotoolbox.org/x/nM616hqU	KOBO_DOCUMENTS_ASSET_UID

Respondents must start from the portal

Do not send the questionnaire's public KoboToolbox link to respondents. Submissions made directly on that link carry no portal signature and are set aside. Always send the personal invitation link.

9.2 Changing a form

- Keep the hidden identifier fields (`master_id`, `sample_id`, `administration_mode`, `respondent_role_category`, `portal_token_id`) and the `SAMPLE_ID_FINAL`, `part_a/KII_ID` and `section_a/DOC_ID` fields unchanged — they link answers to records.
- After redeploying the questionnaire with new required questions, ask the technical administrator to refresh the required-field QA list (`qa_required_fields_from_kobo`).
- Test every change with one test submission launched from a test invitation, then delete the test submission in KoboToolbox.

9.3 Instrument decisions (PI, 15 September 2026)

Question	Decision
Questionnaire Section 10 (Optional Routed Evidence Module)	Shown to every consenting respondent; all questions optional, exactly as the frozen v3.0 instrument. No routing added.
Document tool: records rated Exclude	Keep Section A–B provenance and screening; skip Sections C–L. Publication/event date stays free text so year-only dates are accepted.
KII respondent category list	Confirmed identical to the frozen KII Guide v3.0 (10 named categories + Other).
KII Executive Short Form	Source wording restored: 'Ask K1, K2, K3, K7 and K9 below', each question labelled with its source code. Data columns EXEC1–EXEC5 unchanged. Redeployed 15 September 2026.
Answers from a participant who later withdraws	Kept for the audit trail, never analysed: left out of the analysis export, marked in the operational export and KoboToolbox downloads.

9.4 Rotating the KoboToolbox password and API token

1. Sign in to KoboToolbox (<https://kf.kobotoolbox.org>) and change the account password.

2. In **Account settings** → **Security**, generate a new API token.
3. On the server, run `sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/configure-kobo.sh` and paste the new token when asked. The script never displays it.
4. In the portal, open **QA Queue** and select **Sync now**; the panel should report a successful run.

10. System administration

10.1 Creating and managing accounts (PI)

1. For a whole team, fill in **docs/templates/ABF-FST_Staff_Accounts_Template.xlsx** and run `manage.py create_staff_accounts --file <sheet> --dry-run`, then again without `--dry-run` (add `--assign-cases` to share the shared account's Main cases among the new Contact RAs by province). Temporary passwords go to a private credentials file, never the screen. For one person:
2. Open <https://research.agribizframework.com/django-admin/> and sign in with the PI account.
3. Select **Users** → **Add user**, enter a username and a strong temporary password, and save.
4. On the next page, set the person's name and **email** (used for **Email to me**), choose the **Role** under **ABF-FST role**, and save.
5. Give the person their username and temporary password separately and ask them to change it at first sign-in (**Change password**).
6. When someone leaves the team, untick **Active** on their user record. Never delete users: their audit history must remain.
7. Reassign a departing Contact RA's cases with **Reassign cases** on the Main-400 Register before deactivating them.

10.2 Server operations (technical administrator)

Task	Command (on the server, as root)
Deploy an update	<code>sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/deploy.sh</code>
Roll back the last deploy	<code>sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/rollback.sh</code>
Check go-live readiness without changing data	<code>cd /srv/agribiz-drp/backend && sudo -u agribiz-drp venv/bin/python manage.py golive_preflight</code>
Connect or reconnect KoboToolbox	<code>sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/configure-kobo.sh</code>
Turn on AI-assisted document drafting and PROIT research	<code>sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/configure-ai-coding.sh</code>
Set up outgoing email (Gmail App Password)	<code>sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/configure-email.sh</code>
Enable encrypted Google Drive backups	<code>sudo bash /srv/agribiz-drp/deploy/configure-offsite-backup.sh</code>
Check services	<code>systemctl status drp-backend drp-frontend drp-celery-worker drp-celery-beat nginx</code>

Secrets never go in chat or email

Passwords, API tokens, App Passwords and backup encryption keys are typed only into the configuration scripts on the server. Store the backup encryption key in a password manager: without it the offsite backups cannot be restored.

The AI account is a paid Anthropic account, watch its balance

Document drafting and PROIT research are both paid requests against the same Anthropic account (console.anthropic.com), billed by tokens used. PROIT research runs on a lower-cost model than document drafting. If a screen reports “the AI account has run out of credit”, add credit (or set up auto-reload) on that account's Billing page; no portal setting needs to change. Check Usage/Cost there periodically, and consider a monthly spend limit.

10.3 Backups

- The database and private KoboToolbox files are backed up on the server every 4 hours.
- Once offsite backup is configured, each backup is encrypted and copied to Google Drive.
- Recovery targets: lose at most 4 hours of data, restore within 4 hours.

11. Data protection and ethics in practice

- Treat everything in the portal as **confidential research data**. Do not screenshot, copy, print or forward names, phone numbers, email addresses or answers except as your role requires.
- Never share your username or password, and never sign in for someone else.
- Use the respondent's contact details **only** to manage their participation in this study (invitations, reminders, appointments).
- Never tell a respondent, lender or anyone else that answers affect financing. The study generates **no score, rating or financing decision**.
- If a respondent asks to withdraw, stop contacting them and tell the Field Coordinator or PI the same day so the withdrawal is recorded.
- Report a lost device, a suspected account compromise, or data sent to the wrong person to the PI immediately.

11.1 What respondents are told (PIS v1.4, summary)

- The study, the researcher, the supervisors and the CUT ethics clearance.
- The questionnaire takes around 15–25 minutes, online or with a researcher by phone or WhatsApp.
- Public information may be looked up beforehand and shown for confirmation; they may skip that step.
- Participation is voluntary; they may decline or stop at any time without consequence.
- No score, rating or financing decision is produced; individual answers are never shared with lenders.
- Names and contact details are kept separately from answers, used only to manage participation, and results are reported only in combined, anonymised form.
- Contact: Happyson Saina, 0773943709, abffst.research@gmail.com.

12. Troubleshooting

12.1 Staff

Situation	Likely cause	What to do
"This screen isn't part of your role"	The screen belongs to another role (often an old bookmark or shared link).	Select Go to my start screen. If you need that screen, ask the PI about your role.
"Too many sign-in attempts from this network"	Sign-in is rate-limited per network; an office shares one address.	Wait a minute and try again. A wrong password says so explicitly.
A register shows fewer rows than expected	Registers show 20 rows per page to begin with; a Contact RA sees only assigned cases.	Choose more rows under Show at the foot of the list, use the page numbers or Next, or search. Ask the Field Coordinator to assign the case.
A button is greyed out	A required step is missing (a note, an authenticity decision, a selection).	Read the message beside the button; complete the missing step first.
"KoboToolbox couldn't be reached"	KoboToolbox is slow or the connection token has changed.	Try again in a few minutes. If it persists, tell the PI.
Form PDFs says "Not in sync with KoboToolbox yet"	The counts differ: a form was submitted or changed in KoboToolbox since the last sync (it runs every 15 minutes).	Select Sync now. If it still differs, or says it couldn't reach KoboToolbox, try again in a few minutes and tell the PI if it persists.
A document says "Already submitted" and its answers are locked	Its coding was already sent to KoboToolbox; changing it here would not change that record.	To redo the coding, delete that record in KoboToolbox, then select Sync now on Form PDFs. The document unlocks.
A page keeps loading	A slow or dropped connection.	Refresh the page. Your saved work is not lost; unsaved typing may be.
A file upload seems stuck	A large file on a slow connection takes time; the bar shows how much has been sent.	Wait for Saving... and the file name. If it fails, try again or upload a smaller version.

12.2 Respondents

Respondent says	Likely cause	What to do
"The link says it's not valid"	Mistyped, expired (14 days), revoked, or replaced by a newer link.	Check the case's invitation history; send a new invitation.
"I'm not the right person"	They are not in a senior, knowledgeable role.	Ask them to nominate the right person; record and invite that person.
"It won't let me pick a time"	The time chosen is in the past.	Choose a future date and time.
"The questionnaire won't open"	Weak connection or a busy service.	Select Try again, or Ask a researcher to help me instead; offer a call.
"Will this affect our financing?"	Understandable concern.	No. No score, rating or financing decision is produced, and answers are never shared with lenders.

Respondent says	Likely cause	What to do
"I want to stop / withdraw"	Their right at any time.	Thank them, stop contact, and have the Field Coordinator or PI record the withdrawal.

13. Glossary

Term	Meaning
ABF-FST	Agribusiness Bankability Framework for Food Systems Transformation — the doctoral study this portal supports.
Main-400 / Reserve-400	The 400 selected organisations and their 400 locked, matched replacements.
Master ID	System-generated organisation identifier, e.g. MID-HA-000001 (province code + sequence).
Sample ID	System-generated case identifier, e.g. SID-2026-000001. Never typed by hand, never reused.
Stratum	The sampling cell: Province × Actor family × Size class.
Case	One organisation's place in the sample (a Sample ID).
Workflow status	Where a Main case is, from S00 Selected to S11 Completed, or a drop state (S12–S15).
Invitation	A personal link (valid 14 days) plus an 8-character manual code, issued per case.
Eligibility	The respondent's confirmation that they hold a senior, knowledgeable role.
Consent	The respondent's recorded agreement to take part (participation consent). KII recording consent is separate.
PIS	Participant Information Sheet, currently version 1.4.
AI research	In PROIT, an AI searches public sources for an organisation and the respondent's published professional role and proposes background facts with sources. A researcher accepts or rejects each; nothing enters the profile automatically.
Interview sheet	The locked pre-interview profile as the interviewer uses it: public facts to confirm, gaps to ask, and where the respondent's answers stand.
Reconciliation	After the interview, the researcher's coded value for each fact the respondent corrected or qualified. A case is not complete until its profile is reconciled.
Protocol deviation	A recorded reason why a profile could not be reconciled. It releases the case but leaves it flagged.
PROIT	Pre-Interview Respondent & Organisation Intelligence and Verification Tool: background facts found before contact, confirmed by the respondent.
KoboToolbox	The external data-collection service that hosts the three study forms.
Submission	One completed KoboToolbox form.
Sync	Bringing the portal's own copy of the three KoboToolbox forms level with KoboToolbox. Automatic every 15 minutes, or Sync now.
QA	Quality assurance: automated checks plus a human decision on every questionnaire.
QA exception	An automated flag raised by a QA rule, worked and closed by a person.
KII	Key Informant Interview (target 60 completed).
Documentary evidence	Documents, digital platform and media sources analysed (target 50–75).
Source file	The uploaded scan, PDF, photo or document a documentary record is coded from. Stored privately; it can be removed or replaced.

Term	Meaning
Auto-fill	A button on a document's page that has AI read the source file and draft the whole Document Analysis Tool for you to review. It never submits anything by itself.
AI draft	The AI's proposed answers to the Document Analysis Tool: editable, reviewed by a person, and only sent to KoboToolbox when that person selects Submit.
Page range	The pages of a long PDF that make up one evidence unit (up to 100), entered for Auto-fill.
Copy for another chapter	A button on a document record: makes a new record for a different part of the same source, with the same details and its own copy of the file.
Quick add	Documents → New document → upload a file: the AI fills in the record's details and drafts the coding form for you to review.
Record details	A document's title, author, date, type, scope, value chain and source. They feed Section A of the coding form and can be corrected on the record page.
Read in parts	Auto-fill option for a PDF over 100 pages: the AI codes each part of about 80 pages, then combines them into one draft.
Administration mode	How the questionnaire was completed (codes 01–06).
Follow-up	An approved reminder due to be sent to an invited respondent (Day 2, Day 7).
Withdrawal	A participant's request to stop taking part, recorded once in the portal.
Audit log	The permanent record of every sensitive action and who took it.
Data lock	30 November 2026 — the date fieldwork data is frozen for analysis.

Appendix A. Quick reference

Staff sign-in	https://research.agribizframework.com/admin/login
Respondent links	<a href="https://research.agribizframework.com/i/<personal code>">https://research.agribizframework.com/i/<personal code>
Account administration (PI)	https://research.agribizframework.com/django-admin/
KoboToolbox	https://kf.kobotoolbox.org
Study email	abffst.research@gmail.com
PI phone	0773943709
Invitation validity	14 days
Reminders	Day 2 and Day 7
QA duration limits	5 to 90 minutes
Targets	400 questionnaires · 60 KIs · 50–75 documents
Data lock	30 November 2026

Administration modes

Code	Mode	What happens
01	Web self-administration	The respondent completes the questionnaire alone from the link.
02	WhatsApp link, self-completion	The link is sent by WhatsApp; the respondent completes it alone.
03	Telephone, interviewer-administered	A researcher calls and completes the form while the respondent answers.
04	WhatsApp call, interviewer-assisted	As 03, over a WhatsApp voice or video call.
05	Video call, interviewer-assisted	As 03, over Teams, Zoom or Google Meet.
06	Face to face	In person; the researcher operates the device.